

Measure Theory

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Problem

Consider a random (infinite) string of 0's and 1's

$$(\ell_1, \dots, \ell_n, \dots) \quad \ell_n \in \{0, 1\} \forall n \in \mathbb{N}$$

What is the probability that somewhere along the string, I find 100 consecutive zeros?

Comment

The statement of the problem is unclear. Lebesgue's machinery will clarify this

Define

$$X = \{x = (\ell_1, \dots, \ell_n, \dots) \mid \ell_n \in \{0, 1\} \forall n \in \mathbb{N}\}$$

This is, in a natural way, a compact metric space. Use the "Hamming-style" distance:

For $x = (\ell_1, \dots, \ell_n, \dots)$ and $x' = (\ell'_1, \dots, \ell'_n, \dots)$

$$d(x, x') = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{|\ell_n - \ell'_n|}{2^n}$$

Since this is a metric space, we can consider the topology:

$$\mathcal{T} = \{G \subseteq X \mid G \text{ is open}\} \subseteq 2^X = \mathcal{P}(X)$$

Can consider

$$\mathfrak{B} = \sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathcal{T}) \quad (\text{Borel sigma algebra})$$

Then a probability measure is

$$P : \mathcal{B} \longrightarrow [0, 1]$$

Problem 1.1 says:

Let

$$S = \{x = (\ell_1, \dots, \ell_n, \dots) \in X \mid \exists m \in \mathbb{N} \text{ with } \ell_m = \ell_{m+1} = \dots = \ell_{m+99} = 0\}$$

check that $S \in \mathcal{B}$, and compute $P(S)$

1 Algebras of Sets

Fix a non-empty set X .

Definition 1.1**Algebra of Sets**

$\mathfrak{A} \subseteq 2^X$ is an *algebra of sets* if

1. $\emptyset \in \mathfrak{A}$
2. If $A \in \mathfrak{A}$, then $X \setminus A \in \mathfrak{A}$
3. If $A, B \in \mathfrak{A}$, then $A \cap B \in \mathfrak{A}$

Proposition 1.2**Properties of algebras of sets**

Let $\mathfrak{A}$ be an algebra of sets on X . Then

1. $X \in \mathfrak{A}$
2. If $A, B \in \mathfrak{A}$, then $A \cup B \in \mathfrak{A}$
3. If $A, B \in \mathfrak{A}$, then $A \setminus B \in \mathfrak{A}$
4. If $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq \mathfrak{A}$ is finite, then $\bigcap \mathfrak{B} \in \mathfrak{A}$
5. If $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq \mathfrak{A}$ is finite, then $\bigcup \mathfrak{B} \in \mathfrak{A}$

Example 1.1

Obviously, 2^X and $\{\emptyset, X\}$ are algebras of sets on X

Lemma 1.3**Intersections of algebras**

Let $\mathfrak{F}$ be any collection of algebras of sets on X , then $\bigcap \mathfrak{F}$ is an algebra of sets on X .

Proof: First note if $\mathfrak{F} = \emptyset$, then $\bigcap \mathfrak{F} = 2^X$ which is an algebra of sets on X . We now proceed with checking the axioms of an algebra of sets on X .

1. For every $\mathfrak{A} \in \mathfrak{F}$, we have $\emptyset \in \mathfrak{A}$, thus $\emptyset \in \bigcap \mathfrak{F}$.
2. If $A \in \bigcap \mathfrak{F}$, then $A \in \mathfrak{A}$ for every $\mathfrak{A} \in \mathfrak{F}$. Thus $X \setminus A \in \mathfrak{A}$ for every $\mathfrak{A} \in \mathfrak{F}$, and thus $X \setminus A \in \bigcap \mathfrak{F}$.
3. If $A, B \in \bigcap \mathfrak{F}$, then $A, B \in \mathfrak{A}$ for every $\mathfrak{A} \in \mathfrak{F}$. Thus $A \cap B \in \mathfrak{A}$ for every $\mathfrak{A} \in \mathfrak{F}$, and thus $A \cap B \in \bigcap \mathfrak{F}$.

□

Proposition 1.4**Algebra generated by a collection**

Let $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq 2^X$ be any collection of subsets of X , then there exists a unique algebra of sets $\mathfrak{A}$ on X with the following properties:

1. $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq \mathfrak{A}$
2. Whenever $\mathfrak{C}$ is an algebra of sets on X with $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq \mathfrak{C}$, then we have $\mathfrak{A} \subseteq \mathfrak{C}$

Proof: Define $\mathfrak{F}$ to be the collection of all algebras of sets on X that contain $\mathfrak{B}$. Then $\bigcap \mathfrak{F}$ is an algebra of sets by [Intersections of algebras \(Lemma 1.3\)](#) and satisfies (1) and (2). Uniqueness follows from (2).

□

Definition 1.5**Algebra of sets generated by a collection of subsets**

Let $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq 2^X$ be any collection of subsets of X . We define the *algebra of sets generated by $\mathfrak{B}$* to be the unique algebra from [Algebra generated by a collection \(Proposition 1.4\)](#). We notate it as $\text{Alg}(\mathfrak{B})$.

1.1 Additive set-function on an algebra of sets

Definition 1.6

Additive set-function

Let $\mathfrak{A} \subseteq 2^X$ be an algebra of sets on X . A function $\mu : \mathfrak{A} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ is called an *additive set-function on $\mathfrak{A}$* if

1. If $A, B \in \mathfrak{A}$ with $A \cap B = \emptyset$, then $\mu(A \cup B) = \mu(A) + \mu(B)$
2. $\mu(\emptyset) = 0$

Remark 1.7

The arithmetic of $[0, \infty]$ is standard, except for $0 \cdot \infty = \infty \cdot 0 = 0$, which is a useful convention in measure theory.

Remark 1.8

We almost don't need to require (2), it's just when μ is identically ∞ do things go wrong without (2)

Proposition 1.9

Properties of an additive set function

Let $\mathfrak{A}$ be an algebra of sets on X , and let μ be an additive set function on $\mathfrak{A}$. Then

1. If $A, C \in \mathfrak{A}$ with $A \subseteq C$, then $\mu(A) \leq \mu(C)$
2. If $A, B \in \mathfrak{A}$, then $\mu(A \cup B) \leq \mu(A) + \mu(B)$ (sub additivity)
3. If $A_1, \dots, A_n \in \mathfrak{A}$ are all pairwise disjoint, then $\mu(A_1 \cup \dots \cup A_n) = \mu(A_1) + \dots + \mu(A_n)$
4. If $A_1, \dots, A_n \in \mathfrak{A}$, then $\mu(A_1 \cup \dots \cup A_n) \leq \mu(A_1) + \dots + \mu(A_n)$

2 Sigma Algebras

Definition 2.1

Sigma Algebra

$\mathfrak{M} \subseteq 2^X$ is called a *sigma algebra* on X if

1. $\emptyset \in \mathfrak{M}$
2. If $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, then $X \setminus A \in \mathfrak{M}$
3. If $(A_n)_{n=1}^\infty \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$, then $\bigcap_{n=1}^\infty A_n \in \mathfrak{M}$

Remark 2.2

countable unions work too, and so do finite operations

Lemma 2.3

Intersections of sigma algebras

Let $\mathfrak{F}$ be any collection of sigma algebras on X , then $\bigcap \mathfrak{F}$ is a sigma algebra on X .

Proof: basically identical to the proof for algebras of sets □

Proposition 2.4**Sigma algebra generated by a collection**

Let $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq 2^X$ be any collection of subsets of X , then there exists a unique sigma algebra $\mathfrak{A}$ on X with the following properties:

1. $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq \mathfrak{A}$
2. Whenever $\mathfrak{C}$ is a sigma algebra on X with $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq \mathfrak{C}$, then we have $\mathfrak{A} \subseteq \mathfrak{C}$

Proof: basically identical to the proof for algebras of sets □

Definition 2.5**Sigma algebra generated by a collection of subsets**

Let $\mathfrak{B} \subseteq 2^X$ be any collection of subsets of X . We define the *sigma algebra generated by $\mathfrak{B}$* to be the unique sigma algebra from [Sigma algebra generated by a collection \(Proposition 2.4\)](#). We notate it as $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{B})$.

Definition 2.6**Borel Sigma Algebra**

Given a topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$, the sigma algebra generated by $\mathcal{T}$ is called the *Borel sigma algebra on X* and written $\mathcal{B}_X := \sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathcal{T})$

2.1 Positive measure on a sigma algebra**Remark 2.7****Increasing limits and series in $[0, \infty]$**

1. Let $(s_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be an *increasing* sequence in $[0, \infty]$ in the sense that

$$s_1 \leq s_2 \leq \dots$$

Such a sequence is sure to approach a limit $L \in [0, \infty]$. With a slight abuse of notation we can also write the formula $L = \sup\{s_n \mid n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ meaning that L is the smallest upper bound for all the s_n 's. This is usually written in connection to a bounded increasing sequence of numbers in $[0, \infty)$ – our “slight abuse of notation” is that we are also allowing it to cover the case $L = \infty$, which can occur when some of the s_n 's are equal to ∞ , or when $(s_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is an unbounded sequence in $[0, \infty)$.

2. Let $(t_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be any sequence in $[0, \infty]$. We can consider the finite sums

$$s_n := \sum_{i=1}^n t_i$$

which forms an increasing sequence in $[0, \infty]$. We can consider $L = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} s_n$ as in (1.), and use the familiar notation $L = \sum_{n=1}^\infty t_n$

Definition 2.8**Positive measure**

Let $\mathfrak{M} \subseteq 2^X$ be sigma algebra of subsets of X . We say $\mu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ is a *positive measure* on $\mathfrak{M}$ if it satisfies:

1. $\mu(\emptyset) = 0$

2.
$$\mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu(A_n)$$

Whenever $(A_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is a sequence of sets in $\mathfrak{M}$ with the property that if $i, j \in \mathbb{N}$ with $i \neq j$ we have $A_i \cap A_j = \emptyset$

Remark 2.9

A positive measure is, in particular, finitely additive. Thus we can use all the properties in [Properties of an additive set function \(Proposition 1.9\)](#)

Definition 2.10**Nomenclature involving measures**

1. If $\mathfrak{M}$ is a sigma algebra on X , then the pair $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ is called a *measurable space*
2. If we also have a positive measure μ on $\mathfrak{M}$, then the triple $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ is called a *measure space*
3. If $\mu(X) < \infty$, then we say μ is a *finite measure*
4. If $\mu(X) = 1$, then we say μ is a *probability measure* and that $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ is a *probability space*
5. We say that μ is *sigma finite* if there exists a sequence of sets $(X_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ in $\mathfrak{M}$ with
 - a. $X_1 \subseteq X_2 \subseteq \dots$ (The X_n 's are said to form an increasing chain)
 - b. $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} X_n = X$
 - c. $\mu(X_n) < \infty$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$

Proposition 2.11**Sigma sub-additivity**

Let $\mathfrak{M}$ be a sigma algebra on X , and let μ be a positive measure on $\mathfrak{M}$. If $(A_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is a sequence of sets in $\mathfrak{M}$, then

$$\mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) \leq \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu(A_n)$$

Proposition 2.12**Continuity along chains**

Let $\mathfrak{M}$ be a sigma algebra on X , and let μ be a positive measure on $\mathfrak{M}$.

1. If $(A_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is an increasing chain in $\mathfrak{M}$, then

$$\mu\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(A_n)$$

2. If $(A_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is a decreasing chain in $\mathfrak{M}$ with $\mu(A_1) < \infty$, then

$$\mu\left(\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(A_n)$$

Example 2.1

Example of “atomic” μ based on weights of individual points $x \in X$. Suppose you have $w : X \rightarrow [0, \infty]$. Let $\mathfrak{M} = 2^X$, for every $A \subseteq X$, put

$$\mu(A) = \sup \left\{ \sum_{x \in F} w(x) \mid F \subseteq A \text{ finite} \right\}$$

Then $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ is a measure space. For the special case that $w(x) = 1, \forall x \in X$ is called the *counting measure* on X . For the special case that $w(x_0) = 1$ for some $x_0 \in X$ and $w(x) = 0, \forall x \neq x_0$ is called the *Dirac measure concentrated at x_0*

2.2 A glimpse of the Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{R}$ **Note**

1. $\mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$ can be generated from the half open intervals
2. If $\mu, \nu : \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ are positive measures such that

$$\mu((a, b]) = \nu((a, b]) < \infty, \forall a < b \in \mathbb{R}$$

It follows that $\mu = \nu$

Then the *Lebesgue measure* $\lambda : \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ is determined via with requirement that $\lambda((a, b]) = b - a, \forall a < b \in \mathbb{R}$.

Another approach: λ is uniquely determined by the requirement that $\lambda(B + t) = \lambda(B)$ for every $B \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$ and $t \in \mathbb{R}$ with the normalization that $\lambda((0, 1]) = 1$.

Note

For the *existence* of λ , will invoke an extension theorem of Caratheodory (to be done later)

Note

Interesting fact: there is no positive measure $\mu : 2^{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ which is translation invariant and $\mu((0, 1]) = 1$. This shows, in particular that $\mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}} \neq 2^{\mathbb{R}}$

3 Measurable functions**Definition 3.1****Measurable function**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}), (Y, \mathfrak{N})$ be measurable spaces and $f : X \rightarrow Y$. Then f is called $\mathfrak{M}/\mathfrak{N}$ -measurable if $f^{-1}(N) \in \mathfrak{M}$ for every $N \in \mathfrak{N}$.

Remark 3.2

Pre-images behave nicely with respect to the usual set operations.

Proposition 3.3**Composition of measurable maps**

Compositions of measurable maps are measurable.

Proof: Obvious □

Proposition 3.4**Measurability criterion**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}), (Y, \mathfrak{N})$ be measurable spaces. $f : X \rightarrow Y$, and $\mathfrak{C} \subseteq \mathfrak{N}$ such that $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{C}) = \mathfrak{N}$ and such $f^{-1}(C) \in \mathfrak{M}$ for every $C \in \mathfrak{C}$. Then f is measurable.

Proof: Let $\mathfrak{Q} = \{Q \subseteq Y \mid f^{-1}(Q) \in \mathfrak{M}\} \subseteq 2^Y$

Claim: $\mathfrak{Q}$ is a sigma algebra

Note by assumption $\mathfrak{C} \subseteq \mathfrak{Q}$ thus $\mathfrak{N} = \sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{C}) \subseteq \mathfrak{Q}$. Thus f is measurable. □

Corollary 3.5**Continuous maps are measurable**

Let X, Y be topological spaces, $f : X \rightarrow Y$ continuous. Then f is $\mathcal{B}_X/\mathcal{B}_Y$ -measurable.

3.1 The space of functions $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ **Definition 3.6****Borel measurable real-valued functions**

Given a measurable space $(X, \mathfrak{M})$. Define

$$\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}) := \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \mid f \text{ is } \mathfrak{M}/\mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}} \text{ - measurable}\}$$

Proposition 3.7**Algebra and lattice operations**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ be a measurable space with $f, g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. Then

1. $f + g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$
2. For any $c \in \mathbb{R}$, $cf \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$
3. $f \cdot g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$
4. $f \vee g, f \wedge g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$

Proof of 3: Let $f, g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. Let $h : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ given by $h(x) = (f(x), g(x))$. Let $p : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ given by $p(s, t) = s \cdot t$.

Claim: h is measurable

Claim: p is measurable

Claim: $f \cdot g = p \circ h$

Thus $f \cdot g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ □

Exercise 3.1

Let $\mathfrak{S}$ be the collection of open squares in $\mathbb{R}^2$. Then $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{S}) = \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}^2}$.

Remark 3.8

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ be a measurable space. Then $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ is an *algebra of functions* and a *lattice of functions*.

Remark 3.9

Operations with only one function. If $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, then $|f| \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. Use algebraic stability properties to prove this.

Example 3.1**Problem 3.1**

Claim: Let $\mathfrak{C} = \{(-\infty, t], \mid t \in \mathbb{R}\} \subseteq \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$. Then $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{C}) = \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$.

Proof: Denote $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{C}) = \mathfrak{P}$. Clearly, $\mathfrak{P} \subseteq \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$. If we can show that $G \in \mathfrak{P}$ for all $G \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ open, then we will be done because we will have that $\mathfrak{P}$ is a sigma-algebra and that $\mathfrak{P} \supseteq \mathcal{T}_{\mathbb{R}}$.

Now, every $\emptyset \neq G \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ open can be written as a countable union of open intervals. So then, it suffices to check that $\mathfrak{P}$ contains all of the open intervals of $\mathbb{R}$. This is left as an exercise. □

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ be a measurable space, and suppose $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ satisfies $f^{-1}((-\infty, t]) \in \mathfrak{M}$ for all $t \in \mathbb{R}$. That is, $f^{-1}(C) \in \mathfrak{M}$ for all $C \in \mathfrak{C}$. Then by [Measurability criterion \(Proposition 3.4\)](#), $f^{-1}(B) \in \mathfrak{M}$ for all $B \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$, hence $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

4 Convergence properties of $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$

Proposition 4.1

Closure under suprema and infima

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ be a measurable space.

1. Let $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function. Let $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a sequence of functions in $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$\sup\{f_n(x) \mid n \in \mathbb{N}\} = f(x)$$

for all $x \in X$. Then it follows that $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

2. Let $g : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function. Let $(g_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a sequence of functions in $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$\inf\{g_n(x) \mid n \in \mathbb{N}\} = g(x)$$

for all $x \in X$. Then it follows that $g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Proof:

1. It suffices to show that $f^{-1}((-\infty, t]) \in \mathfrak{M}$ for all $t \in \mathbb{R}$. This is left as an exercise.
2. Exercise.

□

Remark 4.2

Let $(t_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a bounded sequence in $\mathbb{R}$. Then there exists $\ell_+ \in \mathbb{R}$ such that

1. There exists a subsequence of $(t_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ which converges to ℓ_+ .
2. There is no subsequence of $(t_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ which converges to an $\ell > \ell_+$.

Define

$$\limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} t_n := \ell_+$$

We can obtain ℓ_+ as

$$\ell_+ = \lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \left(\sup_{n \geq k} t_n \right) = \inf_{k \geq 1} \left(\sup_{n \geq k} t_n \right)$$

We can define $\liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} t_n$ similarly.

Fix a measurable space $(X, \mathfrak{M})$

Proposition 4.3

1. Let $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. Suppose we could find $f_1, f_2, \dots \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that for every $x \in X$, the sequence $(f_n(x))_{n=1}^\infty$ is bounded with

$$\limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = f(x)$$

Then it follows that $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$

2. Let $g : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. Suppose we could find $g_1, g_2, \dots \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that for every $x \in X$, the sequence $(g_n(x))_{n=1}^\infty$ is bounded with

$$\liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} g_n(x) = g(x)$$

Then it follows that $g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$

Proof of 1: For every $k \in \mathbb{N}$, define the helper function $h_k : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$h_k(x) = \sup \underbrace{\{f_n(x) \mid n \geq k\}}_{\text{bounded by hypothesis}}, \quad \forall x \in X$$

Observe $f_k, f_{k+1}, \dots \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. We can invoke [Closure under suprema and infima \(Proposition 4.1\)](#), to conclude that $h_k \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. Observe for every $x \in X$, we have

$$h_1(x) \geq h_2(x) \geq \dots$$

with

$$f(x) = \lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} h_k(x) = \inf\{h_k(x) \mid k \in \mathbb{N}\}$$

This is because $f(x) = \limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x)$ by hypothesis. But then

$$h_k \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}), \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{N}$$

and

$$f(x) = \inf\{h_k(x) \mid k \in \mathbb{N}\} \quad \forall x \in X$$

thus $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ by [Closure under suprema and infima \(Proposition 4.1\)](#). □

Proof of 2: We can reduce to (1), by introducing $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, $f(x) = -g(x) \quad \forall x \in X$ and introducing $f_n = -g_n \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}$, then apply (1) to $f(x) = \limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x)$, to get $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, hence $g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. □

Corollary 4.4

Let $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. Suppose we could find $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ in $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $f(x) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x)$, $\forall x \in X$. Then it follows that $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Proof: Use [Proposition 4.3](#). □

Exercise 4.1

Suppose that $(X, \mathfrak{M}) = (\mathbb{R}, \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}})$. Let $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be differentiable and consider the function $f' : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ (f' may not be continuous).

Solution:

Idea is to produce $(f_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ in $\text{Bor}(\mathbb{R}, \mathbb{R})$ such that $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = f'(x)$. If we find the f_n 's then $f' \in \text{Bor}(\mathbb{R}, \mathbb{R})$ due to [Corollary 4.4](#). How do we find the f_n 's? For $x \in \mathbb{R}$

$$f'(x) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{f(x + \frac{1}{n}) - f(x)}{\frac{1}{n}} = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} n(u_n(x) - f(x))$$

With $u_n(x) = f(x + \frac{1}{n})$. So then, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let $u_n : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be defined by $u_n(x) = f(x + \frac{1}{n})$, $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}$ and let $f_n = n(u_n - f)$. Every f_n is continuous, hence in $\text{Bor}(\mathbb{R}, \mathbb{R})$ by [Continuous maps are measurable \(Corollary 3.5\)](#) and $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = f'(x)$ as we wanted.

4.1 Approximation by simple functions**Definition 4.5****Simple functions**

A function $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ is said to be *simple* when it takes finitely many values, that is $f(X)$ is a finite subset of $\mathbb{R}$. We denote

$$\text{Bor}_s(X, \mathbb{R}) := \{f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid f \text{ is simple}\}$$

We also introduce the spaces

$$\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) = \{f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid f(x) \geq 0 \forall x \in X\}$$

and

$$\text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) := \text{Bor}_s(X, \mathbb{R}) \cap \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$$

Note

For $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, we have $\chi_A \in \text{Bor}_s(X, \mathbb{R})$, where $\chi_A : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is defined by

$$\chi_A(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } x \in A \\ 0 & \text{if } x \in X \setminus A \end{cases}$$

called the *indicator function* of A . Also note that χ_A is $\mathfrak{M}/\mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$ -measurable since for every $S \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$ we have that

$$\chi_A^{-1}(S) \in \{\emptyset, A, X \setminus A, X\} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$$

Note

It can be shown that

$$\text{Bor}_s(X, \mathbb{R}) = \underbrace{\text{span}\{\chi_A \mid A \in \mathfrak{M}\}}_{\substack{\text{set of all linear combinations} \\ \text{of indicator functions} \\ \chi_A \text{ with } A \in \mathfrak{M}}}$$

Remark 4.6**Binning values of a non-negative Borel function**

Let $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let $f_n : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be the n -th binning of the values of f , defined as follows. For each $x \in X$:

1. If $f(x) \geq n$, define $f_n(x) := n$.
2. If $f(x) < n$, pick the unique $k \in \{1, \dots, n \cdot 2^n\}$ such that

$$\frac{k-1}{2^n} \leq f(x) < \frac{k}{2^n}$$

and define $f_n(x) := \frac{k-1}{2^n}$.

Proposition 4.7**Binning approximation**

Let $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, and for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let f_n be the n -th binning of the values of f . Then

1. $f_n \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$
2. $f_n \leq f_{n+1}$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$
3. For every $x \in X$,

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = f(x)$$

5 Integration of functions in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ **5.1 The map $L_s^+ : \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$**

Fix a measure space $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$

Note

For didactical reasons, it is convenient to first define $\int_X f(x) d\mu(x)$ for $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. In this case, the integral is always defined but may be ∞ . For general $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, the integral may not be defined; to get a finite integral, we need $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$.

Moreover, it will be convenient to introduce the integral on $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ as a map

$$L^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty].$$

We will get L^+ in two parts:

1. Define $L_s^+ : \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$
2. Extend L_s^+ to a map $L^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$

The map $L_s^+ : \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$

Remark 5.1**Easily verified properties of $\text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$**

1. If $f, g \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, then $f + g \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$
2. If $f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $\alpha \in [0, \infty)$, then $\alpha f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$
3. If $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, then $\chi_A \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$

Note

As a consequence of (3), taking $A = \emptyset$ and $A = X$, we get $\underline{1}, \underline{0} : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Theorem 5.2**Integral of non-negative simple functions**

There exists a map

$$L_s^+ : \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \longrightarrow [0, \infty],$$

uniquely determined, such that the following conditions are satisfied:

(i) Additivity:

$$L_s^+(f + g) = L_s^+(f) + L_s^+(g)$$

for all $f, g \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$

(ii) Positive homogeneity:

$$L_s^+(\alpha f) = \alpha L_s^+(f)$$

for all $f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $\alpha \in [0, \infty)$

(iii) Relation to the measure:

$$L_s^+(\chi_A) = \mu(A)$$

for all $A \in \mathfrak{M}$

In order to prove the existence of the map L_s^+ , we will take advantage of the fact that one can describe the functions from $\text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ in terms of measurable divisions of X .

Definition 5.3**Measurable division and intersections of measurable divisions**

1. A *measurable division* of X is a set $\{A_1, \dots, A_n\} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$ of pairwise disjoint, non-empty sets such that $\bigcup_{i=1}^n A_i = X$
2. Given two measurable divisions $\Delta = \{A_1, \dots, A_n\}$ and $\Gamma = \{B_1, \dots, B_m\}$ of X , one can “intersect” them, to form a new measurable division of X , denoted $\Delta \wedge \Gamma$, defined by

$$\Delta \wedge \Gamma := \{A_i \cap B_j \mid 1 \leq i \leq n, 1 \leq j \leq m, \text{ and } A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset\}$$

Lemma 5.4**Simple functions and measurable divisions**

Let $f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$.

1. There exists a measurable division $\Delta = \{A_1, \dots, A_n\}$ of X and numbers $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n \in [0, \infty)$ such that

$$f = \alpha_1 \chi_{A_1} + \dots + \alpha_n \chi_{A_n}$$

2. Suppose that $\Delta = \{A_1, \dots, A_n\}$ and $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n \in [0, \infty)$ are as in (1.), and suppose that $\Gamma = \{B_1, \dots, B_m\}$ is a second measurable division of X . Then

$$f = \sum_{\substack{1 \leq i \leq n, \\ 1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} \alpha_i \chi_{A_i \cap B_j}$$

Proof of 2: For every $1 \leq i \leq n$, write

$$\chi_{A_i} = \chi_{A_i} \cdot 1 = \chi_{A_i} (\chi_{B_1} + \dots + \chi_{B_m}) = \sum_{j=1}^m \chi_{A_i \cap B_j} = \sum_{\substack{1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} \chi_{A_i \cap B_j}$$

Then

$$f = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i \chi_{A_i} = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i \left(\sum_{\substack{1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} \chi_{A_i \cap B_j} \right) = \sum_{\substack{1 \leq i \leq n, \\ 1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} \alpha_i \chi_{A_i \cap B_j}$$

as desired. □

Lemma 5.5**Well-definedness of the simple integral formula**

Let $f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Suppose we have two ways of writing f as a linear combination:

$$f = \alpha_1 \chi_{A_1} + \dots + \alpha_n \chi_{A_n}$$

and

$$f = \beta_1 \chi_{B_1} + \dots + \beta_m \chi_{B_m},$$

where $\Delta = \{A_1, \dots, A_n\}$ and $\Gamma = \{B_1, \dots, B_m\}$ are measurable divisions of X , and $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n, \beta_1, \dots, \beta_m \in [0, \infty)$. Then

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i \mu(A_i) = \sum_{j=1}^m \beta_j \mu(B_j) \in [0, \infty].$$

Proof: For every $1 \leq i \leq n$, let us write

$$A_i = A_i \cap X = A_i \cap (B_1 \cup \dots \cup B_m) = \bigcup_{j=1}^m (A_i \cap B_j) = \bigcup_{\substack{1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} (A_i \cap B_j)$$

Since the union is disjoint,

$$\mu(A_i) = \sum_{\substack{1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} \mu(A_i \cap B_j)$$

so

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i \mu(A_i) = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i \sum_{\substack{1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} \mu(A_i \cap B_j) = \sum_{\substack{1 \leq i \leq n, \\ 1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} \alpha_i \mu(A_i \cap B_j)$$

Similarly,

$$\sum_{j=1}^m \beta_j \mu(B_j) = \sum_{j=1}^m \beta_j \sum_{\substack{1 \leq i \leq n, \\ B_j \cap A_i \neq \emptyset}} \mu(B_j \cap A_i) = \sum_{\substack{1 \leq i \leq n, \\ 1 \leq j \leq m, \\ A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset}} \beta_j \mu(A_i \cap B_j)$$

Claim: If $A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset$, then $\alpha_i = \beta_j$

Observe that this claim will finish the proof. To verify the claim, suppose $A_i \cap B_j \neq \emptyset$. Pick $x \in A_i \cap B_j$, and evaluate $f(x)$ in two ways:

$$f(x) = \alpha_1 \chi_{A_1}(x) + \dots + \alpha_n \chi_{A_n}(x) = \alpha_i$$

similarly

$$f(x) = \beta_1 \chi_{B_1}(x) + \dots + \beta_m \chi_{B_m}(x) = \beta_j,$$

so $\alpha_i = f(x) = \beta_j$

□

Proof of existence of L_s^+ from *Integral of non-negative simple functions (Theorem 5.2)*: For every $f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, we define the quantity $L_s^+(f) \in [0, \infty]$ by the following procedure:

Consider a writing

$$f = \alpha_1 \chi_{A_1} + \dots + \alpha_n \chi_{A_n}$$

with $\Delta = \{A_1, \dots, A_n\}$ a measurable division of X and $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n \in [0, \infty)$,
and put

$$L_s^+(f) := \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i \mu(A_i) \in [0, \infty].$$

The map $L_s^+ : \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \longrightarrow [0, \infty]$

Well-definedness of the simple integral formula (Lemma 5.5) assures us that the procedure $(*)$ is coherent, in the sense that the proposed quantity $L_s^+(f)$ only depends on f and not on the choice of how we write f as a linear combination of indicators.

With $(*)$, we have thus defined a map

$$L_s^+ : \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \longrightarrow [0, \infty].$$

We must now check that this map has the properties (i), (ii), (iii) indicated in **Integral of non-negative simple functions (Theorem 5.2)**. □

5.2 The map $L^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \longrightarrow [0, \infty]$

Definition 5.6

Integral of non-negative Borel functions

For every function $u \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, we define

$$L^+(u) := \sup\{L_s^+(f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\} \in [0, \infty].$$

Remark 5.7

Comments on the formula for L^+

- We use letters such as $u, v, \dots$ for general functions in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, reserving $f, g, \dots$ for functions in $\text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$.
- In the formula above, $f \leq u$ means $f(x) \leq u(x)$ for every $x \in X$.
- The set over which we take the supremum is non-empty because it contains $\underline{0}$.
- The supremum is taken in $[0, \infty]$, so it is allowed to be ∞ .

Proposition 5.8

L^+ extends L_s^+

L^+ is an extension of L_s^+ . That is, if $u \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, then the newly defined quantity $L^+(u)$ is the same as $L_s^+(u)$.

Proof: Must show

$$\sup\{L_s^+(f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\} = L_s^+(u)$$

“ $\geq$ ” holds because $L_s^+(f)$ is an element of $\{L_s^+(f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\}$. For “ $\leq$ ”, we must show $L_s^+(u)$ is an upper bound for $\{L_s^+(f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\}$. Indeed, if $f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ with $f \leq u$, then, using **Integral of non-negative simple functions (Theorem 5.2)**,

$$L_s^+(u) = L_s^+(f + (u - f)) = L_s^+(f) + L_s^+(u - f) \geq L_s^+(f)$$

□

Proposition 5.9

Monotonicity and homogeneity of L^+

1. L^+ is an increasing map: if $u, v \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ with $u \leq v$, then $L^+(u) \leq L^+(v)$
2. L^+ is homogeneous: if $u \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, $\alpha \in [0, \infty)$, then $L^+(\alpha u) = \alpha L^+(u)$

Proof of 1: Since $u \leq v$, we have

The map $L^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \longrightarrow [0, \infty]$

$$\{f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid f \leq u\} \subseteq \{f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid f \leq v\}.$$

Thus

$$\begin{aligned} L^+(u) &= \sup\{L_s^+(f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\} \\ &\leq \sup\{L_s^+(f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq v\} \\ &= L^+(v). \end{aligned}$$

□

Proof of 2: If $\alpha = 0$, then $L^+(\alpha u) = 0 = \alpha L^+(u)$, where we use the convention $0 \cdot \infty = 0$.

Suppose $\alpha > 0$. Then

$$\{g \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid g \leq \alpha u\} = \{\alpha f \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\}.$$

Thus,

$$\begin{aligned} L^+(\alpha u) &= \sup\{L_s^+(\alpha f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\} \\ &= \sup\{\alpha L_s^+(f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\} \\ &= \alpha \sup\{L_s^+(f) \mid f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}), f \leq u\} \\ &= \alpha L^+(u), \end{aligned}$$

where the second equality uses [Integral of non-negative simple functions \(Theorem 5.2\)](#).

□

Remark 5.10

Additivity and MCT

L^+ is additive: $L^+(u + v) = L^+(u) + L^+(v)$ for every $u, v \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. We can show $L^+(u + v) \geq L^+(u) + L^+(v)$ by an easy argument using the definition, but the other inequality is not so easy. Instead we move to the Monotone Convergence Theorem (MCT), which will prove it. Note we have to make sure not to use additivity in the proof of MCT.

6 The Monotone Convergence Theorem

Fix a measure space $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$. We will work with the map $L^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$.

Notation 6.1

Increasing convergence

For u and $u_1, u_2, \dots \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, we will use the shorthand $u_n \nearrow u$ to mean that $u_1 \leq u_2 \leq \dots$ and $u_n \rightarrow u$ pointwise.

Theorem 6.2

Monotone Convergence Theorem

Let $u, u_1, u_2, \dots \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ with $u_n \nearrow u$. Then

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L^+(u_n) = L^+(u)$$

(an increasing limit in $[0, \infty]$)

Proposition 6.3**The missing inequality for additivity of L^+**

Let $u, v \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Then

$$L^+(u + v) \leq L^+(u) + L^+(v).$$

Proof: By [Binning approximation \(Proposition 4.7\)](#), choose sequences $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ and $(g_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ in $\text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $f_n \nearrow u$ and $g_n \nearrow v$. It follows that $(f_n + g_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is a sequence in $\text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $f_n + g_n \nearrow u + v$.

Thus,

$$\begin{aligned} L^+(u + v) &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L^+(f_n + g_n) \\ &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L_s^+(f_n + g_n) \\ &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (L_s^+(f_n) + L_s^+(g_n)) \\ &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (L^+(f_n) + L^+(g_n)). \end{aligned}$$

The first equality uses [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#), the second and fourth use [\$L^+\$ extends \$L_s^+\$ \(Proposition 5.8\)](#), and the third uses [Integral of non-negative simple functions \(Theorem 5.2\)](#).

Now for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, since $f_n \leq u$ and $g_n \leq v$, [Monotonicity and homogeneity of \$L^+\$ \(Proposition 5.9\)](#) gives

$$L^+(f_n) + L^+(g_n) \leq L^+(u) + L^+(v).$$

Hence

$$L^+(u + v) \leq L^+(u) + L^+(v),$$

as desired. □

6.1 Proof of the Monotone Convergence Theorem

Remark 6.4

If $u_n \nearrow u$ in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, then

$$\Lambda := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L^+(u_n) = \sup\{L^+(u_n) \mid n \in \mathbb{N}\} \quad (\text{point-to-prove})$$

will satisfy the inequality $\Lambda \geq L^+(u)$.

To see that this is enough to prove [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#), suppose $u_n \nearrow u$ in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Since $u_n \leq u$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, [Monotonicity and homogeneity of \$L^+\$ \(Proposition 5.9\)](#) gives

$$L^+(u_n) \leq L^+(u)$$

for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Hence $L^+(u)$ is an upper bound for $\{L^+(u_n) \mid n \in \mathbb{N}\}$, so

$$\Lambda = \sup\{L^+(u_n) \mid n \in \mathbb{N}\} \leq L^+(u).$$

Thus, if we prove (point-to-prove), then $\Lambda = L^+(u)$, which is exactly the conclusion of [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#).

We will obtain (point-to-prove) in [Proposition 6.7](#) below. Towards that end, we will prove two special cases of (point-to-prove), which are covered by [Lemma 6.5](#) and [Lemma 6.6](#).

Lemma 6.5

Let $u_1 \leq u_2 \leq \dots \leq u_n \leq \dots$ be in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and let $A \in \mathfrak{M}$ be such that $u_n \nearrow \chi_A$. Consider the increasing limit

$$\Lambda := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L^+(u_n) \in [0, \infty].$$

Then $\Lambda \geq \mu(A)$, where we note that $\mu(A) = L^+(\chi_A)$.

Proof: Assume $A \neq \emptyset$, since if $A = \emptyset$, then $\mu(A) = 0$ and there is nothing to prove. Fix for the moment a $\theta \in (0, 1)$. For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, define

$$A_n := \{x \in A \mid u_n(x) > \theta\}$$

Observe:

1. $A_n \in \mathfrak{M}$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. This is because $A_n = A \cap u_n^{-1}((\theta, \infty))$ with $A, u_n^{-1}((\theta, \infty)) \in \mathfrak{M}$.
2. $A_n \subseteq A_{n+1}$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Indeed, if $x \in A_n$, then $u_n(x) > \theta$, and since $u_n \leq u_{n+1}$, we get $u_{n+1}(x) > \theta$, so $x \in A_{n+1}$.
3. $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n = A$. Indeed, $A_n \subseteq A$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, hence $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n \subseteq A$. For “ $\supseteq$ ”, pick $x \in A$. Since $u_n \nearrow \chi_A$, we have $u_n(x) \rightarrow \chi_A(x) = 1$. Since $\theta < 1$, there exists $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $u_n(x) > \theta$, hence $x \in A_n$.

Thus $(A_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is an increasing chain of sets in $\mathfrak{M}$ with $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n = A$. Using [Continuity along chains \(Proposition 2.12\)](#), we have

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(A_n) = \mu(A) \quad (*)$$

Now observe that for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ we have $u_n \geq \theta \chi_{A_n}$. Indeed, if $x \notin A_n$, then $\theta \chi_{A_n}(x) = 0 \leq u_n(x)$, while if $x \in A_n$, then $\theta \chi_{A_n}(x) = \theta < u_n(x)$.

Hence by [Monotonicity and homogeneity of \$L^+\$](#) (Proposition 5.9), L^+ extends L_s^+ (Proposition 5.8), and [Integral of non-negative simple functions](#) (Theorem 5.2),

$$L^+(u_n) \geq L^+(\theta \chi_{A_n}) = \theta L^+(\chi_{A_n}) = \theta L_s^+(\chi_{A_n}) = \theta \mu(A_n).$$

So we have

$$\text{For every } n \in \mathbb{N}, L^+(u_n) \geq \theta \mu(A_n) \quad (**)$$

Letting $n \rightarrow \infty$ in $(**)$, we get

$$\Lambda \geq \theta \mu(A)$$

where we use $(*)$ for the right-hand side. Finally, unfix θ . We have $\Lambda \geq \theta \mu(A)$ for every $\theta \in (0, 1)$, and hence $\Lambda \geq \mu(A)$, as desired. $\square$

Lemma 6.6

Let $u_1 \leq u_2 \leq \dots \leq u_n \leq \dots$ be in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and let $f_0 \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ be such that $u_n \nearrow f_0$. Consider the increasing limit

$$\Lambda := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L^+(u_n) \in [0, \infty].$$

Then $\Lambda \geq L_s^+(f_0)$, where we note that $L_s^+(f_0) = L^+(f_0)$.

Proposition 6.7

Let $u_n \nearrow u$ in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, and let us consider the increasing limit

$$\Lambda := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L^+(u_n) \in [0, \infty].$$

Then $\Lambda \geq L^+(u)$.

Theorem 6.8

Characterization of L^+

The map $L^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ has the following properties, which determine it uniquely:

- (i) $L^+(\chi_A) = \mu(A)$ for every $A \in \mathfrak{M}$.
- (ii) $L^+(u + v) = L^+(u) + L^+(v)$ for every $u, v \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$.
- (iii) $L^+(\alpha u) = \alpha \cdot L^+(u)$ for every $u \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $\alpha \in [0, \infty)$.
- (iv) $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L^+(u_n) = L^+(u)$ whenever u and $(u_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ are in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $u_n \nearrow u$.

Note

For the existence part in [Characterization of \$L^+\$ \(Theorem 6.8\)](#), property (iv) is [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#), while properties (i), (ii), (iii) follow from [Integral of non-negative simple functions \(Theorem 5.2\)](#), combined with the fact that L^+ is an extension of the map $L_s^+ : \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$.

For the uniqueness part in [Characterization of \$L^+\$ \(Theorem 6.8\)](#), it is convenient to record the following lemma, which will also turn out to be useful in subsequent lectures.

Lemma 6.9**Method of the friendly functions**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ be a measurable space and consider a set of functions $\mathcal{G} \subseteq \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ which has the properties listed below.

- (j) $\chi_A \in \mathcal{G}$ for every $A \in \mathfrak{M}$.
- (jj) If $g_1, g_2 \in \mathcal{G}$, then $g_1 + g_2 \in \mathcal{G}$.
- (jjj) If $g \in \mathcal{G}$ and $\alpha \in [0, \infty)$, then $\alpha g \in \mathcal{G}$.
- (jv) If $g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, $g_1 \leq g_2 \leq \dots \leq g_n \leq \dots$ in $\mathcal{G}$, and $g_n \nearrow g$, then $g \in \mathcal{G}$.

Under these hypotheses, it follows that $\mathcal{G} = \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Proof:

- First, every $f \in \text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ belongs to $\mathcal{G}$. Indeed, by [Simple functions and measurable divisions \(Lemma 5.4\)](#), we can write

$$f = \alpha_1 \chi_{A_1} + \dots + \alpha_n \chi_{A_n}$$

with $A_1, \dots, A_n \in \mathfrak{M}$ and $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n \in [0, \infty)$. By properties (j), (jj), and (jjj), it follows that $f \in \mathcal{G}$.

- Now let $u \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. By [Binning approximation \(Proposition 4.7\)](#), there exists a sequence $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ in $\text{Bor}_s^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $f_n \nearrow u$. By the previous bullet, $f_n \in \mathcal{G}$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and hence property (jv) gives $u \in \mathcal{G}$.

□

Proof of uniqueness in [Characterization of \$L^+\$ \(Theorem 6.8\)](#): Suppose we are given a map

$$M^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$$

which also satisfies the conditions (i)-(iv) in [Characterization of \$L^+\$ \(Theorem 6.8\)](#). Let

$$\mathcal{G} = \{g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid L^+(g) = M^+(g)\} \subseteq \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$$

We will show that $\mathcal{G} = \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ by checking the hypotheses of [Method of the friendly functions \(Lemma 6.9\)](#).

- If $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, then $\chi_A \in \mathcal{G}$ because

$$L^+(\chi_A) = \mu(A) = M^+(\chi_A)$$

- If $g_1, g_2 \in \mathcal{G}$, then $g_1 + g_2 \in \mathcal{G}$ because

$$L^+(g_1 + g_2) = L^+(g_1) + L^+(g_2) = M^+(g_1) + M^+(g_2) = M^+(g_1 + g_2).$$

- If $g \in \mathcal{G}$ and $\alpha \in [0, \infty)$, then $\alpha g \in \mathcal{G}$ because

$$L^+(\alpha g) = \alpha L^+(g) = \alpha M^+(g) = M^+(\alpha g).$$

- Suppose $g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, $g_1 \leq g_2 \leq \dots \leq g_n \leq \dots$ in $\mathcal{G}$, and $g_n \nearrow g$. Then

$$L^+(g) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} L^+(g_n) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} M^+(g_n) = M^+(g),$$

so $g \in \mathcal{G}$.

Thus $\mathcal{G} = \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ by [Method of the friendly functions \(Lemma 6.9\)](#). Hence $L^+(g) = M^+(g)$ for every $g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, so L^+ is uniquely determined. $\square$

7 The space of integrable functions $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$

7.1 Notion of integrable function, the map $L : \mathcal{L}^1(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$

Notation and Remark 7.1

Framework

In this part, we continue to work with the fixed measure space $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ from the previous chapter. There we considered

$$\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) = \{f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid f(x) \geq 0 \ \forall x \in X\}$$

and defined a map $L^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty]$, which is trying to become the integral with respect to μ .

We now want to work with the full space $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. The idea is to reduce a function $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ to a pair of functions $f_+, f_- \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, called the *positive part* and *negative part* of f , defined by

$$f_+ := f \vee \underline{0} \quad \text{and} \quad f_- := (-f) \vee \underline{0}.$$

Here $\vee$ denotes the pointwise maximum of two functions. Equivalently, for every $x \in X$,

$$f_+(x) = \begin{cases} f(x) & \text{if } f(x) \geq 0 \\ 0 & \text{if } f(x) < 0 \end{cases} \quad \text{and} \quad f_-(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } f(x) \geq 0 \\ -f(x) & \text{if } f(x) < 0 \end{cases}.$$

From these formulas we have

$$f_+ + f_- = |f| \quad \text{and} \quad f_+ - f_- = f.$$

We also have the useful expressions

$$f_+ = \frac{f + |f|}{2} \quad \text{and} \quad f_- = \frac{|f| - f}{2}.$$

Lemma 7.2

For $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, we have the equivalence

$$L^+(|f|) < \infty \iff (L^+(f_+) < \infty \text{ and } L^+(f_-) < \infty).$$

Proof: This is immediate from the fact that

$$L^+(|f|) = L^+(f_+) + L^+(f_-),$$

which follows from $|f| = f_+ + f_-$ and the additivity of L^+ from [Characterization of \$L^+\$ \(Theorem 6.8\)](#).

□

Definition 7.3

Integrable functions and the map L

A function $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is said to be *integrable with respect to μ* if $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ and the equivalent conditions from [Lemma 7.2](#) hold. We denote

$$\mathcal{L}^1(\mu) := \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \mid f \text{ is integrable with respect to } \mu\}.$$

We define a map $L : \mathcal{L}^1(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by putting, for every $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$,

$$L(f) := L^+(f_+) - L^+(f_-).$$

Note

We will prove in [Linearity of \$L\$ \(Theorem 7.5\)](#) that the function L is linear. Towards that end, we first prove a lemma which gives some leeway in how $L(f)$ is calculated: instead of having to stick with $f = f_+ - f_-$, the lemma allows us to use a writing $f = h_1 - h_2$.

Lemma 7.4

Let $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and suppose that we can write $f = h_1 - h_2$ with $h_1, h_2 \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $L^+(h_1), L^+(h_2) < \infty$. Then

$$L(f) = L^+(h_1) - L^+(h_2).$$

Proof: Since $f = h_1 - h_2$ and $f = f_+ - f_-$, we have

$$h_1 + f_- = h_2 + f_+.$$

Applying L^+ to both sides, and using additivity from [Characterization of \$L^+\$ \(Theorem 6.8\)](#), gives

$$L^+(h_1) + L^+(f_-) = L^+(h_2) + L^+(f_+).$$

All four quantities appearing here are finite, so we can rearrange this equality to obtain

$$L^+(f_+) - L^+(f_-) = L^+(h_1) - L^+(h_2).$$

The left-hand side is $L(f)$ by definition, and the result follows. □

Theorem 7.5

Linearity of L

- 1 $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ is stable under linear combinations, hence is a linear subspace of $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.
- 2 The map $L : \mathcal{L}^1(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is linear.

Proof of 1: Pick some $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{R}$, and form the linear combination

$$h := \alpha f + \beta g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}).$$

We want to prove that $h \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. Observe that

$$|h| = |\alpha f + \beta g| \leq |\alpha| \cdot |f| + |\beta| \cdot |g|,$$

which implies that

$$\begin{aligned} L^+(|h|) &\leq L^+(|\alpha| \cdot |f| + |\beta| \cdot |g|) \\ &= |\alpha| \cdot L^+(|f|) + |\beta| \cdot L^+(|g|) \\ &< \infty. \end{aligned}$$

The first inequality follows from the fact that L^+ is increasing, and the second equality follows from the additivity and homogeneity properties in [Characterization of \$L^+\$ \(Theorem 6.8\)](#). Since $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, the last expression is finite. It follows that $L^+(|h|) < \infty$, so $h \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ by [Lemma 7.2](#). $\square$

Proof of 2: We will verify separately the two statements which, together, give linearity:

- (a) $L(f + g) = L(f) + L(g)$ for every $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$.
- (b) $L(\alpha f) = \alpha L(f)$ for every $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$.

Verification of (a):

Pick $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. By 1, $f + g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. We can write

$$f + g = (f_+ + g_+) - (f_- + g_-),$$

where $f_+ + g_+$ and $f_- + g_-$ are in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Moreover,

$$L^+(f_+ + g_+) = L^+(f_+) + L^+(g_+) < \infty$$

and

$$L^+(f_- + g_-) = L^+(f_-) + L^+(g_-) < \infty,$$

since $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. Thus [Lemma 7.4](#) gives

$$\begin{aligned} L(f + g) &= L^+(f_+ + g_+) - L^+(f_- + g_-) \\ &= L^+(f_+) + L^+(g_+) - L^+(f_-) - L^+(g_-) \\ &= L(f) + L(g). \end{aligned}$$

Verification of (b):

Pick $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$. By 1, $\alpha f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$.

If $\alpha \geq 0$, then

$$\alpha f = \alpha f_+ - \alpha f_-,$$

and $L^+(\alpha f_+) = \alpha L^+(f_+) < \infty$, $L^+(\alpha f_-) = \alpha L^+(f_-) < \infty$. Hence [Lemma 7.4](#) gives

$$L(\alpha f) = \alpha L^+(f_+) - \alpha L^+(f_-) = \alpha L(f).$$

If $\alpha < 0$, then

$$\alpha f = (-\alpha)f_- - (-\alpha)f_+,$$

and $L^+((-α)f_-) = (-α)L^+(f_-) < ∞$, $L^+((-α)f_+) = (-α)L^+(f_+) < ∞$. Hence [Lemma 7.4](#) gives

$$L(αf) = (-α)L^+(f_-) - (-α)L^+(f_+) = αL(f).$$

□

Proposition 7.6

1. If $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and also $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, then $L(f) = L^+(f)$.
2. If $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ are such that $f \leq g$, then $L(f) \leq L(g)$.
3. If $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, then $|f| \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ as well, and

$$|L(f)| \leq L(|f|).$$

Proof of 1: Since $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, we have $f_+ = f$ and $f_- = \underline{0}$. Hence

$$L(f) = L^+(f_+) - L^+(f_-) = L^+(f) - L^+(\underline{0}) = L^+(f).$$

□

Proof of 2: If $f \leq g$, then $g - f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ by [Linearity of \$L\$ \(Theorem 7.5\)](#), and moreover $g - f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. By part 1,

$$L(g - f) = L^+(g - f) \geq 0.$$

Using the linearity of L , this says that $L(g) - L(f) \geq 0$, hence $L(f) \leq L(g)$.

□

Proof of 3: Since $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, both $L^+(f_+)$ and $L^+(f_-)$ are finite. Hence

$$\begin{aligned} |L(f)| &= |L^+(f_+) - L^+(f_-)| \\ &\leq L^+(f_+) + L^+(f_-) \\ &= L(f_+) + L(f_-) \\ &= L(f_+ + f_-) \\ &= L(|f|). \end{aligned}$$

The second equality uses part 1, the third uses linearity of L , and the last uses $f_+ + f_- = |f|$.

□

Notation and Remark 7.7**Switching to integral notation**

For our measure space $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$, we have now constructed two maps

$$L^+ : \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow [0, \infty] \quad \text{and} \quad L : \mathcal{L}^1(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R},$$

which are trying to become “the integral with respect to μ ”. If $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ is such that both values $L^+(f)$ and $L(f)$ are defined, then [Proposition 7.6](#) says that $L(f) = L^+(f)$.

It is therefore safe to switch to the customary integral notation:

if at least one of $L^+(f), L(f)$ is defined, we denote that value by

$$\int_X f(x) \, d\mu(x).$$

This is often abbreviated to just $\int f \, d\mu$.

While we now have uniform notation for all our integrals, it is useful to remember that the integral notation can have two meanings:

- an L^+ meaning, when it has values in $[0, \infty]$ and we use the properties of L^+ ;
- an L meaning, when it has values in $\mathbb{R}$ and we use the properties of L .

This usually causes no harm. For instance, the inequality from [Proposition 7.6](#) becomes

$$\left| \int_X f(x) \, d\mu(x) \right| \leq \int_X |f(x)| \, d\mu(x), \quad \forall f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu),$$

where the integral on the right-hand side can be viewed either in the L^+ sense or in the L sense.

7.2 Integration of subsets**Notation 7.8**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a measure space.

1. For any $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, we denote

$$\int_A f \, d\mu := \int_X f \cdot \chi_A \, d\mu \in [0, \infty],$$

where, as usual, χ_A denotes the indicator function of A .

2. For any $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, observe that $f \cdot \chi_A \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, since $|f \cdot \chi_A| \leq |f|$. We denote

$$\int_A f \, d\mu := \int_X f \cdot \chi_A \, d\mu \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Proposition 7.9

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a measure space and let $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. We define a set-function $\nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ by putting

$$\nu(A) := \int_A h \, d\mu, \quad A \in \mathfrak{M}.$$

Then ν is a positive measure on $\mathfrak{M}$.

Proof:

1.
$$\nu(\emptyset) = \int_X h \cdot \chi_{\emptyset} \, d\mu = \int_X 0 \, d\mu = 0.$$
2. Fix $(A_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ in $\mathfrak{M}$ such that $A_i \cap A_j = \emptyset$ for $i \neq j$, and let $U = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n$. We must prove that

$$\nu(U) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \nu(A_n).$$

For every $N \in \mathbb{N}$, let

$$s_N = \sum_{n=1}^N h \cdot \chi_{A_n}.$$

Then $(s_N)_{N=1}^{\infty}$ is an increasing sequence in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, and

$$s_N \rightarrow h \cdot \chi_U$$

pointwise. Hence, by [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#),

$$\begin{aligned} \nu(U) &= \int_X h \cdot \chi_U \, d\mu \\ &= \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \int_X s_N \, d\mu \\ &= \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{n=1}^N \int_X h \chi_{A_n} \, d\mu \\ &= \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \nu(A_n). \end{aligned}$$

□

Proposition 7.10

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$, $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, and the positive measure $\nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be as in [Proposition 7.9](#). Then, for every $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$,

$$\int_X f \, d\nu = \int_X f \cdot h \, d\mu \in [0, \infty].$$

This is an equality of integrals considered in the L^+ sense.

Proof: We will use the method of the friendly functions ([Method of the friendly functions \(Lemma 6.9\)](#)). Let

$$\mathcal{G} = \left\{ g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid \int_X g \, d\nu = \int_X g \cdot h \, d\mu \right\}$$

We verify that $\mathcal{G}$ satisfies the conditions of [Method of the friendly functions \(Lemma 6.9\)](#).

- For $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, we have

$$\int_X \chi_A \, d\nu = \nu(A) = \int_A h \, d\mu = \int_X \chi_A \cdot h \, d\mu,$$

so $\chi_A \in \mathcal{G}$.

- If $g_1, g_2 \in \mathcal{G}$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \int_X (g_1 + g_2) \, d\nu &= \int_X g_1 \, d\nu + \int_X g_2 \, d\nu \\ &= \int_X g_1 \cdot h \, d\mu + \int_X g_2 \cdot h \, d\mu \\ &= \int_X (g_1 + g_2) \cdot h \, d\mu, \end{aligned}$$

so $g_1 + g_2 \in \mathcal{G}$.

- If $g \in \mathcal{G}$ and $\alpha \in [0, \infty)$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \int_X \alpha g \, d\nu &= \alpha \int_X g \, d\nu \\ &= \alpha \int_X g \cdot h \, d\mu \\ &= \int_X (\alpha g) \cdot h \, d\mu, \end{aligned}$$

so $\alpha g \in \mathcal{G}$.

- Suppose that $g_1 \leq g_2 \leq \dots \leq g_n \leq \dots$ are in $\mathcal{G}$ and $g_n \rightarrow g$ for some $g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Since $h \geq 0$, we also have $g_n \cdot h \rightarrow g \cdot h$ increasingly. By [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#), applied once with respect to ν and once with respect to μ ,

$$\begin{aligned}
\int_X g \, d\nu &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X g_n \, d\nu \\
&= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X g_n \cdot h \, d\mu \\
&= \int_X g \cdot h \, d\mu.
\end{aligned}$$

Thus $g \in \mathcal{G}$.

Then [Method of the friendly functions \(Lemma 6.9\)](#) gives $\mathcal{G} = \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, which means that

$$\int_X g \, d\nu = \int_X g \cdot h \, d\mu$$

for all $g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, as required. □

Note

In connection with [Proposition 7.10](#), it is customary to write the connection between the positive measures μ and ν in the form

$$d\nu = h \, d\mu.$$

This can be thought of as cancelling the common integral expression in

$$\int_X f \, d\nu = \int_X f \cdot h \, d\mu.$$

Some further abuse of notation rewrites this relation as

$$h = \frac{d\nu}{d\mu},$$

where one thinks of h as a kind of “derivative” of ν with respect to μ .

8 Lebesgue’s Dominated Convergence Theorem (LDCT)

Fix a measure space $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$.

Theorem 8.1**LDCT**

Let f and $(f_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ be functions in $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = f(x), \quad \forall x \in X.$$

Suppose moreover that there exists a function $h \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu) \cap \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ which dominates all the f_n , in the sense that

$$|f_n| \leq h, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Then f and $f_1, f_2, \dots, f_n, \dots$ are all in $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, and

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X f_n \, d\mu = \int_X f \, d\mu.$$

Note

The last equation can be written as

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(\int_X f_n \, d\mu \right) = \int_X \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n \right) d\mu,$$

so this is a formula where one interchanges integration with a limit. In principle, this interchange can have issues. The point of LDCT is that the existence of the dominating function h is a useful sufficient condition which makes the issues go away.

It is convenient to think of LDCT as going in parallel with the MCT from [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#). In connection to that, we will observe in [Reverse-MCT \(Proposition 8.2\)](#) that a special case of LDCT gives a “Reverse-MCT” statement.

Proposition 8.2**Reverse-MCT**

Let u and $(u_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ be functions in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$u_1 \geq u_2 \geq \dots \geq u_n \geq \dots$$

and such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} u_n(x) = u(x), \quad \forall x \in X.$$

(compactly written $u_n \searrow u$). We assume, in addition, that $\int_X u_1 \, d\mu < \infty$. Then

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X u_n \, d\mu = \int_X u \, d\mu.$$

Note

Reverse-MCT is a special case of LDCT because we can use $h = u_1$ as the dominating function. Then [LDCT \(Theorem 8.1\)](#) gives the required conclusion.

For the plan of how we prove LDCT, it is convenient to also consider its special case LDCT_0 , which considers a dominated sequence in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ converging pointwise to 0. This is [LDCT₀ \(Proposition 8.3\)](#).

Proposition 8.3 LDCT_0

Let $(g_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a sequence of functions in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} g_n(x) = 0, \quad \forall x \in X.$$

Suppose moreover that there exists a function $h \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu) \cap \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$g_n \leq h, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Then

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X g_n \, d\mu = 0.$$

Remark 8.4

Scheme of proof of LDCT

We will go in the following way:

$$\text{MCT} \implies \text{Reverse-MCT} \implies \text{LDCT}_0 \implies \text{LDCT}.$$

The first implication is proved by subtracting everything from the top. The second implication uses the trick of Fatou. The third implication is an immediate reduction, by putting

$$g_n := |f_n - f|.$$

8.5. Proof of the implication (1). Since $u_n \searrow u$, we have

$$u_1 - u_n \nearrow u_1 - u.$$

By [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#),

$$\int_X (u_1 - u_n) \, d\mu \rightarrow \int_X (u_1 - u) \, d\mu.$$

Since $0 \leq u, u_n \leq u_1$ and $\int_X u_1 \, d\mu < \infty$, all the integrals below are finite. By linearity,

$$\int_X u_1 \, d\mu - \int_X u_n \, d\mu \rightarrow \int_X u_1 \, d\mu - \int_X u \, d\mu.$$

Cancelling the finite constant $\int_X u_1 \, d\mu$ gives

$$\int_X u_n \, d\mu \rightarrow \int_X u \, d\mu,$$

as required. □

8.6. Proof of the implication (2). The idea is to make a helper sequence $(u_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ to which we can apply [Reverse-MCT \(Proposition 8.2\)](#). We break the proof into steps:

1. For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, define $u_n : X \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ by

$$u_n(x) := \sup\{g_k(x) \mid k \geq n\}.$$

Since each $g_k \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, [Closure under suprema and infima \(Proposition 4.1\)](#) gives $u_n \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. Also $0 \leq u_n \leq h$, so $u_n \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. In particular,

$$\int_X u_1 \, d\mu \leq \int_X h \, d\mu < \infty,$$

where the first inequality uses the monotonicity of L^+ from [Characterization of \$L^+\$ \(Theorem 6.8\)](#), and the finiteness of the last term follows from [Proposition 7.6](#). Finally, from the definition of the tail suprema we have

$$u_1 \geq u_2 \geq \cdots \geq u_n \geq \cdots.$$

2. We claim that $u_n \searrow 0$. Fix $x \in X$ and let $\varepsilon > 0$ be given. Since $g_n(x) \rightarrow 0$, there is $n_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $g_k(x) < \varepsilon$ for all $k \geq n_0$. For this n_0 , we have

$$u_{n_0}(x) = \sup\{g_k(x) \mid k \geq n_0\} \leq \varepsilon.$$

Since the sequence $(u_n(x))_{n=1}^\infty$ is decreasing, it follows that

$$0 \leq u_n(x) \leq u_{n_0}(x) \leq \varepsilon, \quad \forall n \geq n_0.$$

Thus $u_n(x) \rightarrow 0$ for every $x \in X$.

3. Now [Reverse-MCT \(Proposition 8.2\)](#) applied to $(u_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ gives

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X u_n \, d\mu = 0.$$

Since $g_n \leq u_n$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, the monotonicity of L^+ gives

$$0 \leq \int_X g_n \, d\mu \leq \int_X u_n \, d\mu, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Hence $\int_X g_n \, d\mu \rightarrow 0$ as required. □

8.7. Proof of the implication (3). Have f and $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ in $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $f_n(x) \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x)$ for all $x \in X$. Also, we have $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \cap \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ such that $|f_n| \leq h$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. We want $f_n \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and

$$\int_X f_n \, d\mu \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X f \, d\mu$$

- For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} |f_n| \leq h &\implies \int_X |f_n| \, d\mu \leq \int_X h \, d\mu < \infty \\ &\implies f_n \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu) \end{aligned}$$

How about f ? Observe that $|f| \leq h$, which holds because

$$|f(x)| = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |f_n(x)| \leq h(x) \quad \forall x \in X$$

Thus

$$\int_X |f| \, d\mu \leq \int_X h \, d\mu < \infty$$

hence $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ as well. It remains to check that

$$\int_X f_n \, d\mu \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X f \, d\mu$$

Towards that end, consider

$$g_n := |f_n - f| \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}$$

Claim: The g_n 's satisfy the hypothesis of **LDCT₀** ([Proposition 8.3](#)). That is, we have

$$(i) \quad g_n(x) \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} 0 \quad \forall x \in X$$

(ii) There is $\tilde{h} \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \cap \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ such that $g_n \leq \tilde{h}$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$

Verification of Claim:

(i) For every $x \in X$ we have

$$g_n(x) = |f_n(x) - f(x)| \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} 0$$

due to the hypothesis that $f_n(x) \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x)$.

(ii) For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $x \in X$ we have

$$g_n(x) = |f_n(x) - f(x)| \leq |f_n(x)| + |f(x)| \leq 2h(x)$$

Hence $g_n \leq 2h$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, where

$$\int_X 2h \, d\mu = 2 \int_X h \, d\mu < \infty$$

so we can use $\tilde{h} = 2h$

Due to the claim, we can apply **LDCT₀** ([Proposition 8.3](#)) to $(g_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ to get that

$$\int_X g_n \, d\mu \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} 0 \tag{*}$$

This implies the fact that

$$\int_X f_n \, d\mu \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X f \, d\mu$$

because we can write

$$0 \leq \left| \int_X f_n \, d\mu - \int_X f \, d\mu \right| = \left| \int_X f_n - f \, d\mu \right| \leq \int_X |f_n - f| \, d\mu = \int_X g_n \, d\mu \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} 0$$

which completes the proof. □

8.1 The “a.e.- μ ” annoyance (and the “a.e.- μ ” version of LDCT)

Note

A rule of thumb: changes made on a set of measure 0 will not affect integrability or the value of the integral.

Definition 8.8

We say that two functions $f, g : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ are *equal almost everywhere with respect to μ* , denoted $f = g$ a.e.- μ , to mean there exists a set $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$ such that

- (i) $\mu(Z) = 0$.
- (ii) $f(x) = g(x)$ for all $x \in X \setminus Z$.

The preceding definition makes sense even if f and g are not Borel functions. In the case of interest when $f, g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, we can use the following equivalent description of equality almost everywhere.

Proposition 8.9

Let $f, g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, and denote

$$M := \{x \in X \mid f(x) \neq g(x)\}.$$

1. We have $M \in \mathfrak{M}$, hence the quantity $\mu(M)$ is well-defined.
2. We have

$$(f = g \text{ a.e.-}\mu) \iff (\mu(M) = 0).$$

Proof of 1: We can write

$$M = (f - g)^{-1}(\mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\}).$$

Since $f - g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $\mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\} \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$, it follows that $M \in \mathfrak{M}$. □

Proof of 2: “ $\implies$ ” Suppose $f = g$ a.e.- μ . Then there exists $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$ such that $\mu(Z) = 0$ and $f(x) = g(x)$ for every $x \in X \setminus Z$. It follows that $M \subseteq Z$, so $0 \leq \mu(M) \leq \mu(Z) = 0$, hence $\mu(M) = 0$.

“ $\Leftarrow$ ” Suppose $\mu(M) = 0$. Taking $Z := M$, we have $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$ by part 1, $\mu(Z) = 0$, and $f(x) = g(x)$ for every $x \in X \setminus Z$. Hence $f = g$ a.e.- μ . $\square$

Lemma 8.10

Let $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ be such that $f = \underline{0}$ a.e.- μ . Then

$$\int_X f \, d\mu = 0.$$

In particular, $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$.

Proof: For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let $f_n = f \wedge \underline{n}$, where $\underline{n} : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is identically equal to n . That is,

$$f_n(x) = \begin{cases} f(x) & \text{if } f(x) \leq n \\ n & \text{if } f(x) > n \end{cases}$$

We have $f_n \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ because $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ is a lattice of functions. It is also easy to see that $f_n \nearrow f$. By [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#) we have

$$\int_X f \, d\mu = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X f_n \, d\mu.$$

So in order to get $\int_X f \, d\mu = 0$, it suffices to check that $\int_X f_n \, d\mu = 0$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Let $Z = \{x \in X \mid f(x) \neq 0\}$. By [Proposition 8.9](#), we have $\mu(Z) = 0$. Now observe that $f_n \leq n\chi_Z$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$: for $x \in Z$ use that $f_n(x) \leq n = n\chi_Z(x)$, while for $x \in X \setminus Z$ we have $f_n(x) = 0 = n\chi_Z(x)$. Thus

$$\int_X f_n \, d\mu \leq \int_X n\chi_Z \, d\mu = n\mu(Z) = 0,$$

hence $\int_X f_n \, d\mu = 0$ as desired. $\square$

Proposition 8.11

Let $f, g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ be such that $f = g$ a.e.- μ . Suppose that one of these functions, say f , is in $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. Then $g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ as well, and

$$\int_X f \, d\mu = \int_X g \, d\mu.$$

Proof: The hypothesis that $f = g$ a.e.- μ is equivalent to the fact that $|f - g| = \underline{0}$ a.e.- μ . Hence [Lemma 8.10](#) applies to $|f - g|$, and tells us that

$$|f - g| \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \cap \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$$

with

$$\int_X |f - g| \, d\mu = 0.$$

But then $f - g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, since its absolute value is there, and it follows that

$$g = f - (f - g) \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$$

as well, due to the fact that $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ is stable under linear combinations.

Finally, for the statement about the values of the integrals, we write

$$\begin{aligned} \left| \int_X f \, d\mu - \int_X g \, d\mu \right| &= \left| \int_X f - g \, d\mu \right| \\ &\leq \int_X |f - g| \, d\mu \\ &= 0, \end{aligned}$$

and this shows that

$$\int_X f \, d\mu = \int_X g \, d\mu,$$

as required. □

Remark 8.12

The converse of [Lemma 8.10](#) is true as well: if $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $\int_X f \, d\mu = 0$, then it follows that $f = 0$ a.e.- μ .

Proof: Define

$$Z = \{x \in X \mid f(x) \neq 0\} = \{x \in X \mid f(x) > 0\}$$

and for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ let

$$Z_n = \left\{ x \in X \mid f(x) \geq \frac{1}{n} \right\}.$$

Note

$$Z_1 \subseteq Z_2 \subseteq \dots \subseteq Z_n \subseteq \dots$$

and

$$Z = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} Z_n.$$

By [Continuity along chains \(Proposition 2.12\)](#), we have $\mu(Z) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(Z_n)$. So in order to prove $\mu(Z) = 0$, it suffices to prove $\mu(Z_n) = 0$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Indeed, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have $f \geq \frac{1}{n} \chi_{Z_n}$, hence

$$0 = \int_X f \, d\mu \geq \int_X \frac{1}{n} \chi_{Z_n} \, d\mu = \frac{1}{n} \mu(Z_n) \geq 0.$$

so $\mu(Z_n) = 0$ as we wanted. □

Theorem 8.13

a.e- μ -version of LDCT (Theorem 8.1)

Let f and $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be functions in $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that the following hold:

(α) there exists a set $Z_1 \in \mathfrak{M}$ with $\mu(Z_1) = 0$ such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = f(x)$$

for every $x \in X \setminus Z_1$;

(β) there exists a set $Z_2 \in \mathfrak{M}$ with $\mu(Z_2) = 0$ and a function $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \cap \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ such that

$$|f_n(x)| \leq h(x)$$

for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and every $x \in X \setminus Z_2$.

Then f and $f_1, f_2, \dots, f_n, \dots$ are all in $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, and

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X f_n \, d\mu = \int_X f \, d\mu.$$

Proof: Let $Z = Z_1 \cup Z_2$. Note $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$ and $\mu(Z) = 0$. Also note the hypotheses (α), (β) still hold in connection to Z .

Idea: let $\tilde{f} = f\chi_{X \setminus Z}$ and for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ let $\tilde{f}_n = f_n\chi_{X \setminus Z}$. Observe $\tilde{f}$ and $(\tilde{f}_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ satisfy the hypotheses of LDCT (Theorem 8.1): on $X \setminus Z$ this follows from (α), (β), while on Z all these functions vanish. Hence LDCT (Theorem 8.1) can be applied to conclude that $\tilde{f}$ and $\tilde{f}_1, \tilde{f}_2, \dots$ are in $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and

$$\int_X \tilde{f}_n \, d\mu \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X \tilde{f} \, d\mu.$$

On the other hand, observe that $\tilde{f} = f$ a.e- μ and $\tilde{f}_n = f_n$ a.e- μ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then Proposition 8.11 allows us to conclude that $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, with $\int_X f \, d\mu = \int_X \tilde{f} \, d\mu$. Likewise, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $f_n \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and $\int_X f_n \, d\mu = \int_X \tilde{f}_n \, d\mu$. Finally,

$$\int_X \tilde{f}_n \, d\mu \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X \tilde{f} \, d\mu.$$

“becomes”

$$\int_X f_n \, d\mu \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X f \, d\mu.$$

□

9 Basic stuff about the spaces $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$

9.1 Definition of $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\|\cdot\|_p$

We fix a measure space $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$.

Definition of $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\|\cdot\|_p$

Notation and Remark 9.1**The $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ seminorm**

For every $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ we denote

$$\|f\|_1 := \int_X |f| d\mu \in [0, \infty).$$

The map $f \mapsto \|f\|_1$ is often referred to as $\|\cdot\|_1$.

Claim: $\|\cdot\|_1$ is a *seminorm* on $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. This means that $\|\cdot\|_1$ has the following properties:

1. (Non-Negative) $\|f\|_1 \geq 0$ for every $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$.
2. (Sub-Additive) $\|f + g\|_1 \leq \|f\|_1 + \|g\|_1$ for every $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$.
3. (Homogeneous) $\|\alpha f\|_1 = |\alpha| \cdot \|f\|_1$ for every $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$.

Proof: The properties (Non-Negative) and (Homogeneous) are immediate from how $\|\cdot\|_1$ is defined. The verification of (Sub-Additive) also follows easily from the properties of the integral: for every $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$, we first write

$$|f + g| \leq |f| + |g|$$

as an inequality of functions in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, and then we integrate this inequality to get

$$\begin{aligned} \|f + g\|_1 &= \int_X |f + g| d\mu \\ &\leq \int_X |f| + |g| d\mu \\ &= \int_X |f| d\mu + \int_X |g| d\mu \\ &= \|f\|_1 + \|g\|_1. \end{aligned}$$

□

Remark 9.2**Why only a seminorm**

For $\|\cdot\|_1$ to be a *norm*, we would need the implication

$$[\|f\|_1 = 0] \implies [f = \underline{0}]$$

for every $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. But [Lemma 8.10](#) and [Remark 8.12](#) give the weaker equivalence

$$[\|f\|_1 = 0] \iff [f = \underline{0} \text{ a.e. } -\mu].$$

In general, equality almost everywhere does not imply equality at every point of X , so $\|\cdot\|_1$ is only a seminorm on $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. In particular, if there exists a non-empty set $A \in \mathfrak{M}$ with $\mu(A) = 0$, then $\|\cdot\|_1$ is not a norm.

Definition 9.3**The spaces $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and the maps $\|\cdot\|_p$**

Let $p \in [1, \infty)$. We denote

$$\mathcal{L}^p(\mu) := \left\{ f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid \int_X |f|^p d\mu < \infty \right\}$$

for $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, we denote

$$\|f\|_p := \left(\int_X |f|^p d\mu \right)^{\frac{1}{p}} \in [0, \infty)$$

Note that for $p = 1$ we get $\|\cdot\|_1$ on $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$.

Proposition 9.4 **$\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is a linear subspace**

For every $p \in [1, \infty)$, we have that $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is a linear subspace of $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Proof: We need to check that $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is stable under addition and scalar multiplication. Also, $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is non-empty, since it contains the zero-vector $\underline{0}$ of $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Stability under addition. We use the elementary inequality

$$|a + b|^p \leq (2 \max\{|a|, |b|\})^p \leq 2^p(|a|^p + |b|^p), \quad \forall a, b \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Given $f, g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, applying this pointwise gives the inequality

$$|f + g|^p \leq 2^p \cdot |f|^p + 2^p \cdot |g|^p$$

in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Integrating both sides in the L^+ sense gives

$$\int_X |f + g|^p d\mu \leq 2^p \cdot \int_X |f|^p d\mu + 2^p \cdot \int_X |g|^p d\mu.$$

If $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, then the right-hand side is finite, so the left-hand side is finite as well. Hence $f + g \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$.

Stability under scalar multiplication. For $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ and $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, we have $\alpha f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ and

$$\int_X |\alpha f|^p d\mu = \int_X |\alpha|^p \cdot |f|^p d\mu = |\alpha|^p \cdot \int_X |f|^p d\mu < \infty.$$

Thus $\alpha f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$. □

Note**Homogeneity of $\|\cdot\|_p$**

For every $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ and $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, we have

$$\|\alpha f\|_p = \left(\int_X |\alpha f|^p d\mu \right)^{\frac{1}{p}} = \left(|\alpha|^p \cdot \int_X |f|^p d\mu \right)^{\frac{1}{p}} = |\alpha| \cdot \|f\|_p.$$

Remark 9.5**Minkowski inequality**

Pick a number $p \in (1, \infty)$ and consider the question whether $\|\cdot\|_p$ is a seminorm on $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$. If this holds, then it would be an analogue of the fact observed at the beginning of this section that $\|\cdot\|_1$ is a seminorm on $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$.

More precisely, we would like to know whether $\|\cdot\|_p$ has the properties (Non-Negative), (Sub-Additive), and (Homogeneous). The property (Non-Negative) is immediate, and (Homogeneous) is [Homogeneity of \$\|\cdot\|_p\$ \(Note 9.5\)](#). We are left to discuss (Sub-Additive), which is the inequality

$$\|f + g\|_p \leq \|f\|_p + \|g\|_p, \quad \forall f, g \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu).$$

It turns out that this inequality does hold. It is called *Minkowski's inequality*. Its verification poses some difficulties, though: it is not as easy as the corresponding (Sub-Additive) inequality for $\|\cdot\|_1$.

9.2 Conjugate Exponents**Definition 9.6****Conjugate exponents**

In order to get Minkowski's inequality for an exponent $p \in (1, \infty)$, here is the idea: the exponent p has a conjugate exponent $q \in (1, \infty)$, and we can get Minkowski's inequality in the space $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ by playing it against the conjugate space $\mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$.

Two numbers $p, q \in (1, \infty)$ are said to be *conjugate exponents* when they satisfy

$$\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1.$$

Thus, if we are given $p \in (1, \infty)$, then there is precisely one conjugate exponent for it, namely $q := \frac{p}{p-1}$. The idea is that even if we want to prove a result which is just about $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, such as Minkowski's inequality, it can still be useful to bring in the sibling space $\mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$ associated to the conjugate exponent.

Proposition 9.7**Hölder's inequality**

Let $p, q \in (1, \infty)$ be such that $\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1$. One has that if $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$ then $f \cdot g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and

$$\|f \cdot g\|_1 \leq \|f\|_p \cdot \|g\|_q. \quad (\text{Hölder 1})$$

As a consequence, we also have

$$\left| \int_X f \cdot g \, d\mu \right| \leq \|f\|_p \cdot \|g\|_q. \quad (\text{Hölder 2})$$

Note

- Hölder's inequality (Proposition 9.7) can be thought of as a generalization of Cauchy-Schwarz.
- Morally, this introduces a duality between $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$: to every $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ we associate the map $\varphi_f : \mathcal{L}^q(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ given by

$$\varphi_f(g) := \int_X f \cdot g \, d\mu$$

for all $g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$.

Remark 9.8**Cauchy-Schwarz as a special case of Hölder**

Before jumping at the proof of Hölder's inequality (Proposition 9.7), let us pinpoint what the inequality (Hölder 2) amounts to in the important special case when $p = q = 2$. In that case, Hölder's inequality (Proposition 9.7) claims that

$$[f, g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)] \implies [f \cdot g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)].$$

It is customary to introduce an “inner product” notation which takes advantage of the above implication and puts

$$\langle f, g \rangle := \int_X f \cdot g \, d\mu \in \mathbb{R}, \quad \text{for } f, g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

The incarnation of (Hölder 2) that comes up in this way is known as the *Cauchy-Schwarz inequality* for $\mathcal{L}^2$ -functions:

$$|\langle f, g \rangle| \leq \|f\|_2 \cdot \|g\|_2, \quad \forall f, g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu). \quad (\text{Cauchy-Schwarz})$$

We now take on the proof of Hölder's inequality (Proposition 9.7). The first step in that direction is to record the elementary inequality stated in the next lemma.

Lemma 9.9**Young's inequality**

Let $p, q \in (1, \infty)$ be such that $\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1$. For every $a, b \in [0, \infty)$ one has the inequality

$$a \cdot b \leq \frac{1}{p}a^p + \frac{1}{q}b^q. \quad (\circ)$$

Proof: If one of the numbers a, b is equal to 0, then the inequality is clear. So suppose that $a, b > 0$, and let

$$\alpha = \log a \quad \text{and} \quad \beta = \log b.$$

Then $a = e^\alpha$ and $b = e^\beta$, and what we need to prove in (○) becomes

$$e^{\alpha+\beta} \leq \frac{1}{p}e^{\alpha p} + \frac{1}{q}e^{\beta q}. \quad (\circ \circ)$$

Since $\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1$, the right-hand side of $(\bigcirc \bigcirc)$ is a convex combination of the numbers $e^{\alpha p}$ and $e^{\beta q}$. We use the convexity of the exponential function, which gives

$$e^{\frac{1}{p}s + \frac{1}{q}t} \leq \frac{1}{p}e^s + \frac{1}{q}e^t, \quad \forall s, t \in \mathbb{R}. \quad (*)$$

Taking $s = \alpha p$ and $t = \beta q$ gives

$$\frac{1}{p}s + \frac{1}{q}t = \frac{1}{p}(\alpha p) + \frac{1}{q}(\beta q) = \alpha + \beta,$$

hence $(*)$ yields $(\bigcirc \bigcirc)$, as required. □

Now back to the setting of the spaces $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$.

Lemma 9.10

Let $p, q \in (1, \infty)$ be such that $\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1$, and consider two functions $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$. Suppose that $\|f\|_p = \|g\|_q = 1$. Then $f \cdot g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and

$$\|f \cdot g\|_1 \leq 1.$$

Proof: Observe that

$$\|f\|_p = 1 \implies \left(\int_X |f|^p d\mu \right)^{\frac{1}{p}} = 1 \implies \int_X |f|^p d\mu = 1.$$

Likewise,

$$\int_X |g|^q d\mu = 1.$$

Applying [Young's inequality \(Lemma 9.9\)](#) with $a = |f(x)|$ and $b = |g(x)|$, for $x \in X$, gives

$$|f(x)||g(x)| \leq \frac{|f(x)|^p}{p} + \frac{|g(x)|^q}{q}, \quad \forall x \in X.$$

hence

$$|f \cdot g| \leq \frac{1}{p}|f|^p + \frac{1}{q}|g|^q$$

so

$$\begin{aligned} \int_X |f \cdot g| d\mu &\leq \int_X \frac{1}{p}|f|^p + \frac{1}{q}|g|^q d\mu \\ &= \frac{1}{p} \int_X |f|^p d\mu + \frac{1}{q} \int_X |g|^q d\mu \\ &= \frac{1}{p} \cdot 1 + \frac{1}{q} \cdot 1 = 1. \end{aligned}$$

Thus $f \cdot g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and $\|f \cdot g\|_1 \leq 1$. □

Proof of Hölder's inequality (Proposition 9.7): Let $p, q \in (1, \infty)$ with $\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1$, and let $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, $g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$. Put

$$\alpha := \|f\|_p \quad \text{and} \quad \beta := \|g\|_q.$$

We split into cases.

1. Suppose that one of α, β is 0. Say $\alpha = 0$. Then $\int_X |f|^p d\mu = 0$, so [Remark 8.12](#) gives $|f|^p = 0$ a.e.- μ , hence $f = 0$ a.e.- μ . It follows that $f \cdot g = 0$ a.e.- μ , and hence $|f \cdot g| = 0$ a.e.- μ . Since $f \cdot g \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, [Lemma 8.10](#) applied to $|f \cdot g|$ gives

$$\int_X |f \cdot g| d\mu = 0.$$

Thus $f \cdot g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and

$$\|f \cdot g\|_1 = 0 = \alpha \cdot \beta.$$

The case $\beta = 0$ is identical.

2. Suppose that $\alpha, \beta \neq 0$. Let $\tilde{f} = \frac{1}{\alpha}f$ and $\tilde{g} = \frac{1}{\beta}g$. Then $\tilde{f} \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\tilde{g} \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$, with

$$\|\tilde{f}\|_p = 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \|\tilde{g}\|_q = 1.$$

Applying [Lemma 9.10](#) to $\tilde{f}$ and $\tilde{g}$ gives

$$\|\tilde{f} \cdot \tilde{g}\|_1 \leq 1.$$

Since

$$f \cdot g = \alpha \cdot \beta \cdot \tilde{f} \cdot \tilde{g},$$

it follows that $f \cdot g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ and

$$\|f \cdot g\|_1 \leq \alpha \cdot \beta = \|f\|_p \cdot \|g\|_q.$$

This proves (Hölder 1). The inequality (Hölder 2) follows from

$$\left| \int_X f \cdot g d\mu \right| \leq \int_X |f \cdot g| d\mu = \|f \cdot g\|_1.$$

□

9.3 Minkowski's Inequality

We fix $p \in (1, \infty)$, and our goal is to prove Minkowski's inequality for functions in $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$. Towards that goal, we also consider the conjugate exponent $q = \frac{p}{p-1}$ for our fixed p .

Notation and Remark 9.11**Minkowski setup**

Let $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$.

1. We define a function $\varphi_f : \mathcal{L}^q(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by the formula

$$\varphi_f(g) := \int_X f \cdot g \, d\mu, \quad \forall g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu).$$

This definition makes sense due to [Hölder's inequality \(Proposition 9.7\)](#), which assures us that $f \cdot g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ for every $g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$.

2. The map φ_f is linear and has the property that

$$|\varphi_f(g)| \leq \|f\|_p \cdot \|g\|_q, \quad \forall g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu).$$

Indeed, the linearity of φ_f follows from the linearity of the integral, while the inequality is precisely (Hölder 2) from [Hölder's inequality \(Proposition 9.7\)](#).

3. The preceding inequality implies that the set

$$\{|\varphi_f(g)| \mid g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu), \|g\|_q \leq 1\} \subseteq [0, \infty)$$

is bounded from above, with $\|f\|_p$ being an upper bound. We may therefore define

$$\lambda(f) := \sup\{|\varphi_f(g)| \mid g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu), \|g\|_q \leq 1\} \in [0, \infty),$$

and we know that $\lambda(f) \leq \|f\|_p$.

Lemma 9.12**Operator norm formula**

Let $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, and consider the number $\lambda(f) \in [0, \infty)$ defined in [Minkowski setup \(Notation and Remark 9.11\)](#). Then

$$\lambda(f) = \|f\|_p.$$

Proof: The inequality $\lambda(f) \leq \|f\|_p$ was seen in [Minkowski setup \(Notation and Remark 9.11\)](#). In order to prove the reverse inequality, we will display a function $g_0 \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$ such that $\|g_0\|_q \leq 1$ and $\varphi_f(g_0) = \|f\|_p$. For such a function g_0 , we get

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda(f) &= \sup\{|\varphi_f(g)| \mid g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu), \|g\|_q \leq 1\} \\ &\geq |\varphi_f(g_0)| \\ &= \|f\|_p, \end{aligned}$$

as required.

Claim 1: One can find $u \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $|u| = 1$ and $f = u|f|$.

Verification of Claim 1: Define $u : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$u(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } f(x) \geq 0 \\ -1 & \text{if } f(x) < 0. \end{cases}$$

Since $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, we have $u \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. It is immediate from the definition that $|u| = \underline{1}$ and $f = u|f|$.

Claim 2: Let $h = u|f|^{\frac{p}{q}}$, with u as in Claim 1. Then $h \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$ and

1. $\|h\|_q = \|f\|_p^{p-1}$.
2. $\int_X fh \, d\mu = \|f\|_p^p$.

Verification of Claim 2: Since $|u| = \underline{1}$ and $\left(\frac{p}{q}\right)q = p$, we have

$$|h|^q = |f|^p.$$

It follows that $h \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$ and

$$\|h\|_q = \left(\int_X |h|^q \, d\mu \right)^{\frac{1}{q}} = \left(\int_X |f|^p \, d\mu \right)^{\frac{1}{q}} = \|f\|_p^{\frac{p}{q}} = \|f\|_p^{p-1}.$$

Also,

$$fh = (u|f|)(u|f|^{\frac{p}{q}}) = u^2|f|^{1+\frac{p}{q}} = |f|^p,$$

hence

$$\int_X fh \, d\mu = \int_X |f|^p \, d\mu = \|f\|_p^p.$$

We now finish the construction of g_0 . If $\|f\|_p = 0$, we use $g_0 = \underline{0}$. Suppose then that $\|f\|_p \neq 0$. Let h be as in Claim 2, and put

$$g_0 = \frac{1}{\|f\|_p^{p-1}} h.$$

Then $g_0 \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$, and Claim 2 gives

$$\|g_0\|_q = 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \int_X fg_0 \, d\mu = \|f\|_p.$$

□

Proposition 9.13

Minkowski's inequality

For every $f_1, f_2 \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, one has

$$\|f_1 + f_2\|_p \leq \|f_1\|_p + \|f_2\|_p.$$

Proof: By $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is a linear subspace (Proposition 9.4), we know that $f_1 + f_2 \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$. In view of Operator norm formula (Lemma 9.12), it is enough to prove

$$\lambda(f_1 + f_2) \leq \lambda(f_1) + \lambda(f_2). \quad (\diamond)$$

By definition,

$$\lambda(f_1 + f_2) = \sup \left\{ \left| \varphi_{f_1+f_2}(g) \right| \mid g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu), \|g\|_q \leq 1 \right\}.$$

Thus it suffices to check that, for every $g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$ with $\|g\|_q \leq 1$, one has

$$\left| \varphi_{f_1+f_2}(g) \right| \leq \lambda(f_1) + \lambda(f_2). \quad (\diamond_-)$$

So fix $g \in \mathcal{L}^q(\mu)$ with $\|g\|_q \leq 1$. By [Hölder's inequality \(Proposition 9.7\)](#), the functions $f_1 \cdot g$ and $f_2 \cdot g$ are in $\mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. Hence

$$\begin{aligned} \left| \varphi_{f_1+f_2}(g) \right| &= \left| \int_X f_1 \cdot g + f_2 \cdot g \, d\mu \right| \\ &= \left| \int_X f_1 \cdot g \, d\mu + \int_X f_2 \cdot g \, d\mu \right| \\ &\leq \left| \int_X f_1 \cdot g \, d\mu \right| + \left| \int_X f_2 \cdot g \, d\mu \right| \\ &\leq \lambda(f_1) + \lambda(f_2), \end{aligned}$$

where the last line follows from the definition of $\lambda(f_1)$ and $\lambda(f_2)$, since $\|g\|_q \leq 1$. This proves $(\diamond_-)$, and therefore $(\diamond)$. $\square$

Corollary 9.14

$\|\cdot\|_p$ is a seminorm

The map $\|\cdot\|_p$ is a seminorm on the vector space $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$.

Proof: Non-negativity and homogeneity were observed in $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is a linear subspace ([Proposition 9.4](#)), and sub-additivity is precisely [Minkowski's inequality \(Proposition 9.13\)](#). $\square$

Appendix to Chapter 9

A. Null-space of a seminorm, and how to quotient by it

Notation and Remark 90.1

Null-space of a seminorm

Let $\mathcal{V}$ be a vector space over $\mathbb{R}$, and let the map

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{V} &\longrightarrow [0, \infty) \\ v &\longmapsto \|v\|\end{aligned}$$

be a seminorm. The set

$$\mathcal{N} := \{v \in \mathcal{V} \mid \|v\| = 0\} \subseteq \mathcal{V}$$

is called the *null-space* of the seminorm $\|\cdot\|$.

The term “null-space” is justified by the fact that $\mathcal{N}$ is a linear subspace of $\mathcal{V}$. Indeed, $\|0_{\mathcal{V}}\| = 0$, so $0_{\mathcal{V}} \in \mathcal{N}$. If $v_1, v_2 \in \mathcal{N}$, then

$$0 \leq \|v_1 + v_2\| \leq \|v_1\| + \|v_2\| = 0,$$

hence $v_1 + v_2 \in \mathcal{N}$. Finally, if $v \in \mathcal{N}$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, then

$$\|\alpha v\| = |\alpha| \|v\| = 0,$$

so $\alpha v \in \mathcal{N}$.

The seminorm $\|\cdot\|$ is a norm on $\mathcal{V}$ if and only if its null-space is $\mathcal{N} = \{0_{\mathcal{V}}\}$.

Notation and Remark 90.2**Quotient by a linear subspace**

Let $\mathcal{V}$ be a vector space over $\mathbb{R}$, and let $\mathcal{W} \subseteq \mathcal{V}$ be a linear subspace. In order to describe the quotient space $\mathcal{V}/\mathcal{W}$, define a relation $\sim$ on $\mathcal{V}$ by

$$(v_1 \sim v_2) \iff (v_1 - v_2 \in \mathcal{W}).$$

This is an equivalence relation. It is reflexive because $v - v = 0_{\mathcal{V}} \in \mathcal{W}$. It is symmetric because $v_1 - v_2 \in \mathcal{W}$ implies $v_2 - v_1 = -(v_1 - v_2) \in \mathcal{W}$, and it is transitive because

$$v_1 - v_3 = (v_1 - v_2) + (v_2 - v_3) \in \mathcal{W}$$

whenever $v_1 \sim v_2$ and $v_2 \sim v_3$.

Let $\mathcal{Q}$ be the collection of equivalence classes with respect to $\sim$. This collection has a natural vector space structure and is called the *quotient space* $\mathcal{V}/\mathcal{W}$. There is a surjective linear map

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{V} &\longrightarrow \mathcal{Q} \\ v &\longmapsto \hat{v}, \end{aligned}$$

where $\hat{v}$ denotes the equivalence class of v .

Thus we may remember the quotient as

$$\mathcal{Q} = \{\hat{v} \mid v \in \mathcal{V}\},$$

where, for every $v_1, v_2 \in \mathcal{V}$,

$$(\widehat{v_1} = \widehat{v_2}) \iff (v_1 - v_2 \in \mathcal{W}),$$

and “hats respect linear combinations”:

$$\widehat{\alpha_1 v_1 + \alpha_2 v_2} = \alpha_1 \widehat{v_1} + \alpha_2 \widehat{v_2}, \quad \forall v_1, v_2 \in \mathcal{V}, \quad \forall \alpha_1, \alpha_2 \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Remark 90.3**How to get a norm out of a seminorm**

Suppose that the vector space $\mathcal{V}$ is endowed with a seminorm $\|\cdot\|$, let $\mathcal{N}$ be its null-space, and consider the quotient space $\mathcal{Q} = \mathcal{V}/\mathcal{N}$. We define a norm on $\mathcal{Q}$ as follows:

Take $\xi \in \mathcal{Q}$.

Write $\xi = \widehat{v}$ for some $v \in \mathcal{V}$.

Define $\|\xi\|_{\mathcal{Q}} := \|v\| \in [0, \infty)$.

There are three points to verify.

1. The definition is coherent. Suppose $\xi = \widehat{v_1} = \widehat{v_2}$. Then $v_1 - v_2 \in \mathcal{N}$, so $\|v_1 - v_2\| = 0$. By sub-additivity,

$$\|v_1\| \leq \|v_1 - v_2\| + \|v_2\| = \|v_2\|.$$

Interchanging v_1 and v_2 gives the reverse inequality, hence $\|v_1\| = \|v_2\|$.

2. The map $\xi \mapsto \|\xi\|_{\mathcal{Q}}$ inherits the seminorm properties from $\|\cdot\|$. Non-negativity is immediate.

If $\xi = \widehat{v}$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, then

$$\|\alpha\xi\|_{\mathcal{Q}} = \|\widehat{\alpha v}\|_{\mathcal{Q}} = \|\alpha v\| = |\alpha|\|v\| = |\alpha|\|\xi\|_{\mathcal{Q}}.$$

Likewise, if $\xi_1 = \widehat{v_1}$ and $\xi_2 = \widehat{v_2}$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \|\xi_1 + \xi_2\|_{\mathcal{Q}} &= \|\widehat{v_1 + v_2}\|_{\mathcal{Q}} \\ &= \|v_1 + v_2\| \\ &\leq \|v_1\| + \|v_2\| \\ &= \|\xi_1\|_{\mathcal{Q}} + \|\xi_2\|_{\mathcal{Q}}. \end{aligned}$$

3. The resulting seminorm is a norm. Indeed, if $\|\xi\|_{\mathcal{Q}} = 0$ and $\xi = \widehat{v}$, then $\|v\| = 0$, so $v \in \mathcal{N}$. Therefore

$$\xi = \widehat{v} = \widehat{0_{\mathcal{V}}} = 0_{\mathcal{Q}}.$$

B. The quotient space $L^p(\mu)$ of $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$

We return to the usual framework of a measure space $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$. Define

$$\mathcal{N} := \{f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid f = 0 \text{ a.e.} - \mu\}. \quad (90.6)$$

Thus $f \in \mathcal{N}$ means that there exists $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$ with $\mu(Z) = 0$ such that $f(x) = 0$ for every $x \in X \setminus Z$. Equivalently, by [Proposition 8.9](#),

$$\mu(\{x \in X \mid f(x) \neq 0\}) = 0.$$

The definition of $\mathcal{N}$ is independent of the exponent used to define the spaces $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$.

Proposition 90.4

Let $p \in [1, \infty)$. Then the space $\mathcal{N}$ from (90.6) is contained in $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and is precisely the null-space of the seminorm $\|\cdot\|_p$ on $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$.

Proof: Let $f \in \mathcal{N}$. Then $|f|^p = \underline{0}$ a.e.- μ , so [Lemma 8.10](#) gives

$$\int_X |f|^p d\mu = 0.$$

Hence $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\|f\|_p = 0$.

Conversely, suppose that $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\|f\|_p = 0$. Then

$$\int_X |f|^p d\mu = 0.$$

By [Remark 8.12](#), $|f|^p = \underline{0}$ a.e.- μ , which is equivalent to $f = \underline{0}$ a.e.- μ . Thus $f \in \mathcal{N}$. □

Definition 90.5

For every $p \in [1, \infty)$, we denote

$$L^p(\mu) := \mathcal{L}^p(\mu) / \mathcal{N},$$

where $\mathcal{N}$ is the space from (90.6).

By the construction in [How to get a norm out of a seminorm \(Remark 90.3\)](#), the seminorm $\|\cdot\|_p$ on $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ induces a norm on $L^p(\mu)$, which we still denote by $\|\cdot\|_p$. Thus $(L^p(\mu), \|\cdot\|_p)$ is a normed vector space.

Remark 90.6

So what is $L^p(\mu)$, after all?

The quotient $L^p(\mu)$ is a “space of objects with hats”:

$$L^p(\mu) = \{ \hat{f} \mid f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu) \}.$$

For $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, we have

$$(\hat{f} = \hat{g}) \iff (f = g \text{ a.e.-}\mu). \tag{90.9}$$

Indeed,

$$(f - g \in \mathcal{N}) \iff (f - g = \underline{0} \text{ a.e.-}\mu) \iff (f = g \text{ a.e.-}\mu),$$

so (90.9) is exactly the equivalence relation defining the quotient.

Finally, hats respect linear combinations:

$$\widehat{\alpha f + \beta g} = \alpha \hat{f} + \beta \hat{g}, \quad \forall f, g \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu), \quad \forall \alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{R},$$

and the seminorm on $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is transferred to the quotient by putting

$$\|\hat{f}\|_p := \|f\|_p, \quad \forall f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu).$$

By [How to get a norm out of a seminorm \(Remark 90.3\)](#) and [Proposition 90.4](#), this is well-defined and is a norm on $L^p(\mu)$.

10 $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ -Completeness

10.1 Completeness in the framework of a semi-normed vector space

Fix an $\mathbb{R}$ -vector space $\mathcal{V}$ and a seminorm $\|\cdot\| : \mathcal{V} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$. We call the pair $(\mathcal{V}, \|\cdot\|)$ a *semi-normed vector space*.

Definition 10.1

Convergence in a semi-normed space

Let $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a sequence of vectors in $\mathcal{V}$. We say $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ *converges* to $v \in \mathcal{V}$ when $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|v_n - v\| = 0$, and we write $v_n \rightarrow v$. We say $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ *converges* if $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ converges to some $v \in \mathcal{V}$.

Warning 10.2

Non-uniqueness of limits

The limit of a sequence is not uniquely determined. Indeed, if $v_n \rightarrow v \in \mathcal{V}$ and $v_n \rightarrow v' \in \mathcal{V}$, then

$$\|v - v'\| = \|v - v_n + v_n - v'\| \leq \|v_n - v\| + \|v_n - v'\| \rightarrow 0.$$

Thus we can conclude that $\|v - v'\| = 0$, but this does not imply that $v = v'$.

Definition 10.3

Cauchy and geometric sequences

Let $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a sequence of vectors in $\mathcal{V}$.

1. We say $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is a *Cauchy sequence* when, for every $\varepsilon > 0$, we can find $n_o \in \mathbb{N}$ such that whenever $n, m \geq n_o$, we have $\|v_n - v_m\| < \varepsilon$.
2. We say $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is a $\frac{1}{2}$ -*geometric sequence* when

$$\|v_n - v_{n+1}\| \leq \frac{1}{2^n} \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Remark 10.4

Basic sequence facts

We can prove the following statements using the same arguments used in normed vector spaces:

1. if $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is convergent, then it is Cauchy;
2. if $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is $\frac{1}{2}$ -geometric, then it is Cauchy;
3. if $(v_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is Cauchy, then there is a subsequence $(v_{n(k)})_{k=1}^\infty$ that is $\frac{1}{2}$ -geometric.

Definition 10.5

Completeness

A semi-normed space $(\mathcal{V}, \|\cdot\|)$ is said to be *complete* when every Cauchy sequence in $(\mathcal{V}, \|\cdot\|)$ converges.

Remark 10.6**Geometric criterion for completeness**

A familiar fact of normed vector spaces remains true in semi-normed spaces: if every $\frac{1}{2}$ -geometric sequence in $(\mathcal{V}, \|\cdot\|)$ converges, then $(\mathcal{V}, \|\cdot\|)$ is complete.

We can also weaken the hypothesis slightly: if every $\frac{1}{2}$ -geometric sequence $(w_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ in $(\mathcal{V}, \|\cdot\|)$ with $w_1 = 0$ converges, then $(\mathcal{V}, \|\cdot\|)$ is complete.

10.2 Completeness of $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ **Lemma 10.7****Convergence mechanism**

Let $f_1, f_2, \dots, f_n, \dots$ be a sequence of functions from X to $\mathbb{R}$. We consider the helper functions $h_n : X \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ defined by

$$h_1 = |f_1|, \quad h_2 = |f_1| + |f_2 - f_1|, \quad h_3 = |f_1| + |f_2 - f_1| + |f_3 - f_2|, \dots$$

and, in general,

$$h_n = |f_1| + \sum_{m=2}^n |f_m - f_{m-1}|. \quad (10.1)$$

We observe that

$$0 \leq h_1 \leq h_2 \leq \dots \leq h_n \leq \dots$$

and we denote

$$Z := \left\{ x \in X \mid \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} h_n(x) = \infty \right\}. \quad (10.2)$$

Then, for every $x \in X \setminus Z$, the sequence $(f_n(x))_{n=1}^\infty$ is convergent in $\mathbb{R}$. It therefore makes sense to consider the function $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ defined by

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } x \in Z \\ \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) & \text{if } x \in X \setminus Z. \end{cases} \quad (10.3)$$

Proof: Fix $x \in X \setminus Z$. We will show that the sequence of real numbers $(f_n(x))_{n=1}^\infty$ is Cauchy, and hence convergent in $\mathbb{R}$.

Since $x \in X \setminus Z$, the increasing sequence

$$0 \leq h_1(x) \leq h_2(x) \leq \dots \leq h_n(x) \leq \dots$$

has a finite limit $\ell \in [0, \infty)$. Let $\varepsilon > 0$. We can find $n_o \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$h_{n_o}(x) > \ell - \varepsilon.$$

We claim that $|f_m(x) - f_n(x)| < \varepsilon$ whenever $n, m \geq n_o$. By symmetry, it is enough to consider the case $n > m$. In that case,

$$\begin{aligned}
|f_m(x) - f_n(x)| &= \left| \sum_{k=m}^{n-1} (f_k(x) - f_{k+1}(x)) \right| \\
&\leq \sum_{k=m}^{n-1} |f_k(x) - f_{k+1}(x)| \\
&= h_n(x) - h_m(x) \\
&< \ell - (\ell - \varepsilon) \\
&= \varepsilon.
\end{aligned}$$

Here the strict inequality follows because $h_n(x) \leq \ell$, while

$$h_m(x) \geq h_{n_0}(x) > \ell - \varepsilon.$$

Therefore $(f_n(x))_{n=1}^\infty$ is Cauchy and hence converges in $\mathbb{R}$, as required. $\square$

Proposition 10.8

Let $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a sequence of functions in $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ such that $f_1 = \underline{0}$ and

$$\|f_n - f_{n+1}\|_p \leq \frac{1}{2^n}, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Upon applying to the functions $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ the general convergence mechanism from [Convergence mechanism \(Lemma 10.7\)](#), we get a function $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, as described in (10.3).

Claim: We have that $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, and $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|f_n - f\|_p = 0$.

Proof: We will use the helper functions $(h_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ and the set Z defined in (10.1) and (10.2). In addition, define $h : X \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ by

$$h(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } x \in Z \\ \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} h_n(x) & \text{if } x \in X \setminus Z. \end{cases} \quad (10.5)$$

We will reach the required conclusion through a number of claims concerning $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ and the auxiliary functions $(h_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ and h .

Claim 1: For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have $h_n \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\|h_n\|_p \leq 1$.

Verification of Claim 1: We may assume that $n \geq 2$, since the case $n = 1$ is immediate from $h_1 = |f_1| = \underline{0}$.

For every m with $2 \leq m \leq n$, we have $f_m - f_{m-1} \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ by $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is a linear subspace ([Proposition 9.4](#)). It follows that

$$u_m := |f_m - f_{m-1}|$$

belongs to $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, with

$$\|u_m\|_p = \|f_m - f_{m-1}\|_p \leq \frac{1}{2^{m-1}}.$$

Since $f_1 = \underline{0}$, we have

$$h_n = u_2 + \cdots + u_n.$$

Therefore $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is a linear subspace (Proposition 9.4) and $\|\cdot\|_p$ is a seminorm (Corollary 9.14) give $h_n \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, with

$$\begin{aligned} \|h_n\|_p &\leq \|u_2\|_p + \cdots + \|u_n\|_p \\ &\leq \frac{1}{2} + \cdots + \frac{1}{2^{n-1}} \\ &\leq 1. \end{aligned}$$

Claim 2: We have $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$ and $\mu(Z) = 0$. Moreover, the function h from (10.5) belongs to $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and satisfies $\|h\|_p \leq 1$.

Verification of Claim 2: Since every h_n is Borel, we can write

$$Z = \bigcap_{k=1}^{\infty} \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} \{x \in X \mid h_n(x) > k\},$$

which shows that $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$.

We use the following consequence of the Monotone Convergence Theorem, whose proof is left as an exercise.

Exercise 10.1

Let $(u_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ be an increasing sequence in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. If there exists $A \in \mathfrak{M}$ with $\mu(A) > 0$ such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} u_n(x) = \infty, \quad \forall x \in A,$$

then

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X u_n \, d\mu = \infty.$$

Suppose, towards a contradiction, that $\mu(Z) > 0$. By Claim 1, the functions h_n^p are in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, and

$$0 = h_1^p \leq h_2^p \leq \cdots \leq h_n^p \leq \cdots.$$

Moreover, for every $x \in Z$, we have

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} h_n(x)^p = \infty.$$

Applying the exercise to the sequence $(h_n^p)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ would give

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X h_n^p \, d\mu = \infty.$$

On the other hand, Claim 1 gives

$$\int_X h_n^p \, d\mu = \|h_n\|_p^p \leq 1, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N},$$

a contradiction. Hence $\mu(Z) = 0$.

We now consider the sequence $(h_n \chi_{X \setminus Z})_{n=1}^\infty$. Every function in this sequence is in $\text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, and

$$h_n \chi_{X \setminus Z} \nearrow h.$$

In particular, [Corollary 4.4](#) gives $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Applying [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#) to the increasing sequence

$$((h_n \chi_{X \setminus Z})^p)_{n=1}^\infty$$

gives

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X (h_n \chi_{X \setminus Z})^p d\mu = \int_X h^p d\mu.$$

Since $\mu(Z) = 0$, the functions $(h_n \chi_{X \setminus Z})^p$ and h_n^p are equal a.e. $-\mu$. Thus [Proposition 8.11](#) and Claim 1 give

$$\int_X h^p d\mu = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X h_n^p d\mu = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|h_n\|_p^p \leq 1.$$

Therefore $h \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\|h\|_p \leq 1$.

Claim 3: The function f belongs to $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Verification of Claim 3: The function f is the pointwise limit of the sequence

$$(f_n \chi_{X \setminus Z})_{n=1}^\infty.$$

Each function in this sequence belongs to $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$, so [Corollary 4.4](#) gives $f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Claim 4: Fix $n_o \in \mathbb{N}$ and define

$$g = (f_{n_o} \chi_{X \setminus Z}) - f \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R}).$$

Then $g \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$, with

$$\|g\|_p \leq \frac{1}{2^{n_o-1}}.$$

Verification of Claim 4: For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, define

$$g_n = (f_{n_o} - f_n) \chi_{X \setminus Z}.$$

By the definitions of f and g , we have $g_n(x) \rightarrow g(x)$ for every $x \in X$. Moreover,

$$|g_n| \leq h, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Indeed, both sides vanish on Z , while for $x \in X \setminus Z$, the left-hand side is bounded by the sum of the absolute increments between $f_{n_o}(x)$ and $f_n(x)$, which is at most $h(x)$. Hence

$$|g_n|^p \leq h^p, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Since $h^p \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$ by Claim 2, [LDCT \(Theorem 8.1\)](#) applied to the sequence $(|g_n|^p)_{n=1}^\infty$ gives

$$\int_X |g|^p d\mu = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X |g_n|^p d\mu.$$

On the other hand, for $n > n_o$, the functions g_n and $f_{n_o} - f_n$ are equal a.e- μ . Repeatedly applying $\|\cdot\|_p$ is a seminorm (Corollary 9.14) therefore gives

$$\begin{aligned} \|g_n\|_p &= \|f_{n_o} - f_n\|_p \\ &\leq \sum_{m=n_o}^{n-1} \|f_m - f_{m+1}\|_p \\ &\leq \sum_{m=n_o}^{n-1} \frac{1}{2^m} \\ &\leq \frac{1}{2^{n_o-1}}. \end{aligned}$$

It follows that

$$\int_X |g|^p d\mu = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|g_n\|_p^p \leq \left(\frac{1}{2^{n_o-1}} \right)^p < \infty.$$

Thus $g \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and $\|g\|_p \leq \frac{1}{2^{n_o-1}}$.

Claim 5: We have $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$.

Verification of Claim 5: Fix any $n_o \in \mathbb{N}$. Since $\mu(Z) = 0$, we have

$$f_{n_o} \chi_{X \setminus Z} = f_{n_o} \text{ a.e-}\mu.$$

Hence $f_{n_o} \chi_{X \setminus Z} \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$. Claim 4 also gives

$$(f_{n_o} \chi_{X \setminus Z}) - f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu).$$

Since

$$f = f_{n_o} \chi_{X \setminus Z} - ((f_{n_o} \chi_{X \setminus Z}) - f),$$

the linear stability of $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ from $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ is a linear subspace (Proposition 9.4) yields $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$.

Claim 6: We have

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|f_n - f\|_p = 0.$$

Verification of Claim 6: Apply Claim 4 with $n_o = n$. Since f vanishes on Z , we have

$$(f_n \chi_{X \setminus Z}) - f = (f_n - f) \chi_{X \setminus Z} = f_n - f \text{ a.e-}\mu.$$

It follows that

$$\|f_n - f\|_p \leq \frac{1}{2^{n-1}}, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Letting $n \rightarrow \infty$ proves the claim and completes the proof.

□

Corollary 10.9

The semi-normed vector space $(\mathcal{L}^p(\mu), \|\cdot\|_p)$ is complete.

Proof: This follows immediately by combining [Geometric criterion for completeness \(Remark 10.6\)](#) and [Proposition 10.8](#). □

Corollary 10.10

The normed vector space $(L^p(\mu), \|\cdot\|_p)$ is a Banach space.

Proof: Let $(\xi_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a Cauchy sequence in $L^p(\mu)$. For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, choose $f_n \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ such that

$$\xi_n = \widehat{f_n}.$$

By the definition of the vector-space operations and the norm on $L^p(\mu)$, for every $m, n \in \mathbb{N}$ we have

$$\begin{aligned} \|f_m - f_n\|_p &= \|\widehat{f_m - f_n}\|_p \\ &= \|\widehat{f_m} - \widehat{f_n}\|_p \\ &= \|\xi_m - \xi_n\|_p. \end{aligned}$$

Since $(\xi_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is Cauchy in $L^p(\mu)$, it follows that $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is Cauchy in the semi-normed space $(\mathcal{L}^p(\mu), \|\cdot\|_p)$. By [Corollary 10.9](#), there exists $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|f_n - f\|_p = 0.$$

Put $\xi = \widehat{f} \in L^p(\mu)$. Then, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\begin{aligned} \|\xi_n - \xi\|_p &= \|\widehat{f_n} - \widehat{f}\|_p \\ &= \|\widehat{f_n - f}\|_p \\ &= \|f_n - f\|_p. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|\xi_n - \xi\|_p = 0,$$

so $(\xi_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ converges to ξ in $L^p(\mu)$. Thus $L^p(\mu)$ is complete and hence is a Banach space. □

10.3 Modes of convergence

A byproduct of the proof of [Proposition 10.8](#) is that convergence with respect to $\|\cdot\|_p$ can be connected to a notion of almost-everywhere convergence.

Definition 10.11**Almost-everywhere convergence**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a measure space, and let f and $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be functions in $\text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$. We say that $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ *converges to f almost everywhere with respect to μ* , or a.e.- μ for short, if there exists $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$ such that $\mu(Z) = 0$ and

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = f(x), \quad \forall x \in X \setminus Z.$$

The relevance of this definition can be seen in the proof of [Proposition 10.8](#). The function f constructed there also satisfies $f_n(x) \rightarrow f(x)$ for every $x \in X \setminus Z$, and Claim 2 shows that $\mu(Z) = 0$. Thus the sequence converges to f almost everywhere. This gives the following corollary.

Corollary 10.12

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a measure space, let $p \in [1, \infty)$, and let $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ be a sequence in $\mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ such that

$$\|f_n - f_{n+1}\|_p < \frac{1}{2^n}, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Then there exists $f \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ such that $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ converges to f almost everywhere with respect to μ .

Proof: Define $g_n = f_n - f_1$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then $g_1 = \underline{0}$ and

$$\|g_n - g_{n+1}\|_p = \|f_n - f_{n+1}\|_p < \frac{1}{2^n}, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Apply [Proposition 10.8](#) to $(g_n)_{n=1}^\infty$. Its proof produces a function $g \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$ and a set $Z \in \mathfrak{M}$ with $\mu(Z) = 0$ such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} g_n(x) = g(x), \quad \forall x \in X \setminus Z.$$

Put $f = g + f_1 \in \mathcal{L}^p(\mu)$. For every $x \in X \setminus Z$, we then have

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (g_n(x) + f_1(x)) = g(x) + f_1(x) = f(x).$$

Hence $(f_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ converges to f almost everywhere with respect to μ . □

11 Bounded linear functionals on $\mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$

Fix a measure space $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$, and consider the semi-normed vector space $(\mathcal{L}^2(\mu), \|\cdot\|_2)$.

Definition 11.1**Bounded linear functional**

Let $\varphi : \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a linear functional. We say that φ is *bounded* if there exists a constant $c \geq 0$ such that

$$|\varphi(f)| \leq c \cdot \|f\|_2, \quad \forall f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

Remark 11.2**Bounded linear functionals from inner products**

Recall from the special case $p = q = 2$ of [Hölder's inequality \(Proposition 9.7\)](#) that if $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$, then $f \cdot g \in \mathcal{L}^1(\mu)$. We use the inner-product notation

$$\langle f, g \rangle := \int_X f \cdot g \, d\mu \in \mathbb{R},$$

and the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality from the beginning of Lecture 9B says

$$|\langle f, g \rangle| \leq \|f\|_2 \cdot \|g\|_2, \quad \forall f, g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

Consequently, every $f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ determines a bounded linear functional $\varphi_f : \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ given by

$$\varphi_f(g) := \langle f, g \rangle = \int_X f \cdot g \, d\mu, \quad \forall g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

Indeed, Cauchy–Schwarz gives

$$|\varphi_f(g)| \leq \|f\|_2 \cdot \|g\|_2, \quad \forall g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

The theorem below, due to Riesz, states that every bounded linear functional on $\mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ arises in this way.

Theorem 11.3**Riesz representation theorem for $\mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$**

Let $\varphi : \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a bounded linear functional. Then there exists $f_o \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ such that

$$\varphi(g) = \langle f_o, g \rangle, \quad \forall g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

We first establish three lemmas.

Lemma 11.4**Parallelogram law**

For every $f, g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$, we have

$$\|f + g\|_2^2 + \|f - g\|_2^2 = 2\|f\|_2^2 + 2\|g\|_2^2.$$

Proof: Using the pointwise identity $(f + g)^2 + (f - g)^2 = 2f^2 + 2g^2$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \|f + g\|_2^2 + \|f - g\|_2^2 &= \int_X |f + g|^2 \, d\mu + \int_X |f - g|^2 \, d\mu \\ &= \int_X ((f + g)^2 + (f - g)^2) \, d\mu \\ &= 2 \int_X |f|^2 \, d\mu + 2 \int_X |g|^2 \, d\mu \\ &= 2\|f\|_2^2 + 2\|g\|_2^2. \end{aligned}$$

□

Lemma 11.5

Let $\varphi : \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a bounded linear functional which is not identically zero, and let

$$\mathcal{U} := \{u \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \mid \varphi(u) = 1\}.$$

Then:

1. $\mathcal{U}$ is non-empty;
2. the number

$$\alpha_o := \inf\{\|u\|_2 \mid u \in \mathcal{U}\}$$

is strictly positive;

3. there exists $u_o \in \mathcal{U}$ such that $\|u_o\|_2 = \alpha_o$.

Proof of 1: Since φ is not identically zero, choose $f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ such that $\varphi(f) \neq 0$. Put

$$u = \frac{1}{\varphi(f)} f.$$

Then $\varphi(u) = 1$, so $u \in \mathcal{U}$. □

Proof of 2: Let $c \geq 0$ satisfy

$$|\varphi(f)| \leq c \cdot \|f\|_2, \quad \forall f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

We must have $c > 0$, since otherwise φ would be identically zero. For every $u \in \mathcal{U}$,

$$1 = |\varphi(u)| \leq c \cdot \|u\|_2,$$

so $\|u\|_2 \geq \frac{1}{c}$. Hence $\alpha_o \geq \frac{1}{c} > 0$. □

Proof of 3: By the definition of the infimum, choose a sequence $(u_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ in $\mathcal{U}$ such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|u_n\|_2 = \alpha_o.$$

We claim that $(u_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ is Cauchy in $(\mathcal{L}^2(\mu), \|\cdot\|_2)$. Since

$$\varphi\left(\frac{u_n + u_m}{2}\right) = 1,$$

we have $\frac{u_n + u_m}{2} \in \mathcal{U}$, and therefore

$$\left\|\frac{u_n + u_m}{2}\right\|_2 \geq \alpha_o.$$

The parallelogram law now gives

$$\begin{aligned} \|u_n - u_m\|_2^2 &= 2\|u_n\|_2^2 + 2\|u_m\|_2^2 - \|u_n + u_m\|_2^2 \\ &\leq 2\|u_n\|_2^2 + 2\|u_m\|_2^2 - 4\alpha_o^2. \end{aligned}$$

The right-hand side tends to 0 as $n, m \rightarrow \infty$, proving the claim.

By [Corollary 10.9](#), there exists $u_o \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ such that

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|u_n - u_o\|_2 = 0.$$

Boundedness of φ gives

$$|\varphi(u_o) - 1| = |\varphi(u_o - u_n)| \leq c \cdot \|u_o - u_n\|_2 \rightarrow 0,$$

hence $\varphi(u_o) = 1$ and $u_o \in \mathcal{U}$. Finally, the reverse triangle inequality gives

$$|\|u_n\|_2 - \|u_o\|_2| \leq \|u_n - u_o\|_2 \rightarrow 0.$$

Thus $\|u_o\|_2 = \alpha_o$. □

Lemma 11.6

Let $\varphi : \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a bounded linear functional which is not identically zero. Let $\mathcal{U}$ and $u_o \in \mathcal{U}$ be as in [Lemma 11.5](#), and let

$$\mathcal{V} := \{v \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \mid \varphi(v) = 0\} = \ker \varphi.$$

Then

$$\langle u_o, v \rangle = 0, \quad \forall v \in \mathcal{V}.$$

Proof: Fix $v \in \mathcal{V}$. For every $t \in \mathbb{R}$, we have

$$\varphi(u_o + tv) = \varphi(u_o) + t\varphi(v) = 1,$$

so $u_o + tv \in \mathcal{U}$. By the minimizing property of u_o ,

$$\|u_o + tv\|_2^2 \geq \|u_o\|_2^2, \quad \forall t \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Thus the quadratic function

$$q(t) := \|u_o + tv\|_2^2 = \|u_o\|_2^2 + 2t\langle u_o, v \rangle + t^2\|v\|_2^2$$

attains its minimum at $t = 0$. Therefore $q'(0) = 0$. On the other hand,

$$q'(t) = 2\langle u_o, v \rangle + 2t\|v\|_2^2,$$

and hence

$$0 = q'(0) = 2\langle u_o, v \rangle.$$

Thus $\langle u_o, v \rangle = 0$, as required. □

Proof of [Riesz representation theorem for \$\mathcal{L}^2\(\mu\)\$](#) ([Theorem 11.3](#)): If φ is identically zero, take $f_o = \underline{0}$. Suppose that φ is not identically zero. Let $\mathcal{U}$, α_o , and u_o be as in [Lemma 11.5](#). Since $\alpha_o > 0$, we may define

$$f_o = \frac{1}{\|u_o\|_2^2} u_o \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

Fix $g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$. We have the decomposition

$$g = \varphi(g)u_o + \underbrace{g - \varphi(g)u_o}_{\in \ker \varphi}.$$

Indeed, since $\varphi(u_o) = 1$,

$$\varphi(g - \varphi(g)u_o) = \varphi(g) - \varphi(g)\varphi(u_o) = 0.$$

By [Lemma 11.6](#), this term is therefore orthogonal to u_o , and hence

$$\begin{aligned} \langle f_o, g \rangle &= \left\langle \frac{u_o}{\|u_o\|_2^2}, \varphi(g)u_o + (g - \varphi(g)u_o) \right\rangle \\ &= \left\langle \frac{u_o}{\|u_o\|_2^2}, \varphi(g)u_o \right\rangle + \left\langle \frac{u_o}{\|u_o\|_2^2}, g - \varphi(g)u_o \right\rangle \\ &= \frac{\varphi(g)}{\|u_o\|_2^2} \langle u_o, u_o \rangle + \frac{1}{\|u_o\|_2^2} \underbrace{\langle u_o, g - \varphi(g)u_o \rangle}_{=0} \\ &= \frac{\varphi(g)}{\|u_o\|_2^2} \langle u_o, u_o \rangle \\ &= \varphi(g). \end{aligned}$$

This holds for every $g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$, as required. □

12 Radon-Nikodym theorem in the special case when $\nu \leq \mu$

Fix a measurable space $(X, \mathfrak{M})$.

Notation 12.1

Domination of measures

Let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be positive measures. We write $\nu \leq \mu$ if

$$\nu(A) \leq \mu(A), \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{M}.$$

The inequality defining $\nu \leq \mu$ extends to an inequality between integrals.

Proposition 12.2

Monotonicity of integrals with respect to measures

Let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be positive measures such that $\nu \leq \mu$. Then

$$\int_X f \, d\nu \leq \int_X f \, d\mu, \quad \forall f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}).$$

Proof: We use the method of the friendly functions from [Method of the friendly functions \(Lemma 6.9\)](#). Define

$$\mathcal{G} := \left\{ g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}) \mid \int_X g \, d\nu \leq \int_X g \, d\mu \right\}.$$

We verify its four hypotheses.

- If $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, then

$$\int_X \chi_A \, d\nu = \nu(A) \leq \mu(A) = \int_X \chi_A \, d\mu,$$

so $\chi_A \in \mathcal{G}$.

- If $g_1, g_2 \in \mathcal{G}$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \int_X (g_1 + g_2) \, d\nu &= \int_X g_1 \, d\nu + \int_X g_2 \, d\nu \\ &\leq \int_X g_1 \, d\mu + \int_X g_2 \, d\mu \\ &= \int_X (g_1 + g_2) \, d\mu, \end{aligned}$$

so $g_1 + g_2 \in \mathcal{G}$.

- If $g \in \mathcal{G}$ and $\alpha \in [0, \infty)$, then

$$\int_X \alpha g \, d\nu = \alpha \int_X g \, d\nu \leq \alpha \int_X g \, d\mu = \int_X \alpha g \, d\mu,$$

so $\alpha g \in \mathcal{G}$.

- Suppose that $g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, $g_1 \leq g_2 \leq \dots \leq g_n \leq \dots$ in $\mathcal{G}$, and $g_n \nearrow g$. By [Monotone Convergence Theorem \(Theorem 6.2\)](#), applied with respect to ν and μ ,

$$\int_X g \, d\nu = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X g_n \, d\nu \leq \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_X g_n \, d\mu = \int_X g \, d\mu.$$

Hence $g \in \mathcal{G}$.

Therefore [Method of the friendly functions \(Lemma 6.9\)](#) gives $\mathcal{G} = \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, proving the result. $\square$

Remark 12.3

Domination obtained by integrating a density

Let $\mu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be a positive measure and let $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Recall from [Proposition 7.9](#) that

$$\nu(A) := \int_A h \, d\mu = \int_X h \cdot \chi_A \, d\mu, \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{M},$$

defines a positive measure ν ; we write $d\nu = h \, d\mu$.

Suppose, moreover, that $h(x) \leq 1$ for every $x \in X$. For every $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, we then have $h \cdot \chi_A \leq \chi_A$, and hence

$$\nu(A) = \int_X h \cdot \chi_A \, d\mu \leq \int_X \chi_A \, d\mu = \mu(A).$$

Thus $\nu \leq \mu$.

The following important special case of the Radon–Nikodym theorem gives a converse to [Domination obtained by integrating a density](#) ([Remark 12.3](#)).

Theorem 12.4**Radon–Nikodym theorem in the case when $\nu \leq \mu$**

Let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ be finite positive measures such that $\nu \leq \mu$. Then there exists $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $h(x) \leq 1$ for every $x \in X$ and

$$d\nu = h \, d\mu;$$

that is,

$$\nu(A) = \int_A h \, d\mu, \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{M}.$$

Moreover, h is unique in the a.e.– μ sense: if $\tilde{h} \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ also satisfies $d\nu = \tilde{h} \, d\mu$, then $\tilde{h} = h$ a.e.– μ .

Notation and Remark 12.5**Radon–Nikodym derivative**

1. The function h appearing in [Radon–Nikodym theorem in the case when \$\nu \leq \mu\$](#) ([Theorem 12.4](#)) is called the *Radon–Nikodym derivative of ν with respect to μ* . It is commonly denoted by

$$h = \frac{d\nu}{d\mu}.$$

2. The uniqueness assertion in [Radon–Nikodym theorem in the case when \$\nu \leq \mu\$](#) ([Theorem 12.4](#)) is comparatively easy, but equality a.e.– μ is the most one can expect. Indeed, if $d\nu = h \, d\mu$ and $\tilde{h} = h$ a.e.– μ , then [Proposition 8.11](#) gives $d\nu = \tilde{h} \, d\mu$ as well.
3. The difficult part is the existence of h , which will be proved using an $\mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ approach. To motivate it, suppose temporarily that the desired derivative has already been found. Then

$$\int_X g \, d\nu = \int_X g \cdot h \, d\mu, \quad \forall g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}).$$

Since $0 \leq h \leq 1$ and μ is finite, we have $h \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$. Restricting the preceding identity to $g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ gives

$$\langle h, g \rangle = \int_X g \, d\nu.$$

This suggests defining a linear functional $\varphi : \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$\varphi(g) := \int_X g \, d\nu, \quad \forall g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu),$$

and applying [Riesz representation theorem for \$\mathcal{L}^2\(\mu\)\$](#) ([Theorem 11.3](#)). The next two lemmas ensure that this definition makes sense and that φ is bounded.

Lemma 12.6

Suppose $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ are finite positive measures such that $\nu \leq \mu$. Then $\mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \subseteq \mathcal{L}^2(\nu)$, and

$$\|f\|_{2,\nu} \leq \|f\|_{2,\mu}, \quad \forall f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

Proof: Let $f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$. Then

$$\int_X |f|^2 d\mu < \infty.$$

Since $|f|^2 \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$, [Monotonicity of integrals with respect to measures \(Proposition 12.2\)](#) gives

$$\int_X |f|^2 d\nu \leq \int_X |f|^2 d\mu < \infty.$$

Hence $f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\nu)$. The same inequality says that

$$\|f\|_{2,\nu}^2 \leq \|f\|_{2,\mu}^2,$$

and taking square roots gives the desired norm inequality. $\square$

Lemma 12.7

Suppose $\nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ is a finite positive measure. Then $\mathcal{L}^2(\nu) \subseteq \mathcal{L}^1(\nu)$. Moreover, for every $f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\nu)$ we have

$$\left| \int_X f d\nu \right| \leq \sqrt{\nu(X)} \cdot \|f\|_{2,\nu}.$$

Proof: The constant function $\underline{1}$ belongs to $\mathcal{L}^2(\nu)$, with

$$\|\underline{1}\|_{2,\nu} = \sqrt{\int_X \underline{1}^2 d\nu} = \sqrt{\nu(X)}.$$

Thus, for every $f \in \mathcal{L}^2(\nu)$, Cauchy–Schwarz gives $f = f \cdot \underline{1} \in \mathcal{L}^1(\nu)$ and

$$\left| \int_X f d\nu \right| \leq \|f\|_{2,\nu} \cdot \|\underline{1}\|_{2,\nu} = \sqrt{\nu(X)} \cdot \|f\|_{2,\nu}.$$

$\square$

Proof of existence in [Radon–Nikodym theorem in the case when \$\nu \leq \mu\$ \(Theorem 12.4\):](#)

Claim 1: It makes sense to define $\varphi : \mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$\varphi(g) := \int_X g d\nu.$$

Moreover, φ is a bounded linear functional on $\mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$.

Verification of Claim 1: By [Lemma 12.6](#) and [Lemma 12.7](#),

$$\mathcal{L}^2(\mu) \subseteq \mathcal{L}^2(\nu) \subseteq \mathcal{L}^1(\nu),$$

so the integral defining $\varphi(g)$ is finite for every $g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$. Linearity of φ follows from linearity of the integral with respect to ν . Moreover, the same two lemmas give

$$|\varphi(g)| \leq \sqrt{\nu(X)} \cdot \|g\|_{2,\nu} \leq \sqrt{\nu(X)} \cdot \|g\|_{2,\mu}, \quad \forall g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu).$$

Thus φ is bounded.

Claim 2: There exists $f_o \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ such that

$$\int_X g \, d\nu = \int_X f_o \cdot g \, d\mu, \quad \forall g \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu). \quad (\diamond)$$

Verification of Claim 2: Apply [Riesz representation theorem for \$\mathcal{L}^2\(\mu\)\$](#) ([Theorem 11.3](#)) to the bounded linear functional φ from Claim 1.

Claim 3: Let $f_o \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$ be as in Claim 2, and define

$$Z_- := \{x \in X \mid f_o(x) < 0\} \quad \text{and} \quad Z_+ := \{x \in X \mid f_o(x) > 1\}.$$

Then $Z_-, Z_+ \in \mathfrak{M}$ and $\mu(Z_-) = \mu(Z_+) = 0$.

Verification of Claim 3: Since $f_o \in \text{Bor}(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $(-\infty, 0), (1, \infty) \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$, both Z_- and Z_+ belong to $\mathfrak{M}$.

The arguments for Z_- and Z_+ are similar, so we verify only that $\mu(Z_+) = 0$. For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, define

$$Z_n^+ := \left\{ x \in X \mid f_o(x) \geq 1 + \frac{1}{n} \right\}.$$

Then

$$Z_1^+ \subseteq Z_2^+ \subseteq \dots \subseteq Z_n^+ \subseteq \dots \quad \text{and} \quad \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} Z_n^+ = Z_+.$$

By continuity along increasing chains, it is enough to prove that $\mu(Z_n^+) = 0$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Fix $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and let $\chi := \chi_{Z_n^+}$. Since μ is finite, $\chi \in \mathcal{L}^2(\mu)$, so we may substitute it for g in $(\diamond)$. From

$$f_o \cdot \chi \geq \left(1 + \frac{1}{n}\right) \chi,$$

we obtain

$$\nu(Z_n^+) = \int_X f_o \cdot \chi \, d\mu \geq \left(1 + \frac{1}{n}\right) \mu(Z_n^+).$$

On the other hand, $\nu \leq \mu$ gives $\nu(Z_n^+) \leq \mu(Z_n^+)$. Hence

$$\left(1 + \frac{1}{n}\right)\mu(Z_n^+) \leq \mu(Z_n^+),$$

which forces $\mu(Z_n^+) = 0$. Therefore $\mu(Z_+) = 0$. The analogous argument gives $\mu(Z_-) = 0$.

Let f_o , Z_- , and Z_+ be as in Claims 2 and 3, and put

$$h := f_o \cdot (1 - \chi_{Z_- \cup Z_+}).$$

Equivalently,

$$h(x) := \begin{cases} f_o(x) & \text{if } 0 \leq f_o(x) \leq 1 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}.$$

Then $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and $h(x) \leq 1$ for every $x \in X$. Claim 3 also gives $h = f_o$ a.e.- μ . For every $A \in \mathfrak{M}$, substituting $g = \chi_A$ into $(\diamond)$ and using [Proposition 8.11](#) yields

$$\nu(A) = \int_X \chi_A d\nu = \int_X f_o \cdot \chi_A d\mu = \int_X h \cdot \chi_A d\mu = \int_A h d\mu.$$

Hence $d\nu = h d\mu$. □

13 Connecting equation, and Radon-Nikodym for $\nu \ll \mu$

Continue to work with the measurable space $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ fixed previously. We will use [Radon-Nikodym theorem in the case when \$\nu \leq \mu\$](#) ([Theorem 12.4](#)) to obtain a version of the Radon-Nikodym theorem under the weaker hypothesis of absolute continuity $\nu \ll \mu$, rather than the stronger hypothesis $\nu \leq \mu$.

13.1 The trick of the connecting equation

In this section, let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ be finite positive measures, with no relation assumed between them. The idea is to apply [Radon-Nikodym theorem in the case when \$\nu \leq \mu\$](#) ([Theorem 12.4](#)) using the inequalities

$$\mu \leq \mu + \nu \quad \text{and} \quad \nu \leq \mu + \nu.$$

Definition and Remark 13.1

Sum of positive measures

Let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be positive measures. Define $\mu + \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ by

$$(\mu + \nu)(A) := \mu(A) + \nu(A), \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{M}.$$

Then $\mu + \nu$ is itself a positive measure. Moreover,

$$\int_X f d(\mu + \nu) = \int_X f d\mu + \int_X f d\nu, \quad \forall f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}).$$

The integral identity follows from the method of the friendly functions.

Proposition 13.2**Trick of the connecting equation**

Let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ be finite positive measures. There exist $h_1, h_2 \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$h_1(x) + h_2(x) = 1, \quad \forall x \in X,$$

and

$$\int_X g \cdot h_1 \, d\mu = \int_X g \cdot h_2 \, d\nu, \quad \forall g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}). \quad (\heartsuit)$$

Proof: Put $\rho := \mu + \nu$. Then ρ is a finite positive measure and $\nu \leq \rho$. By [Radon–Nikodym theorem in the case when \$\nu \leq \mu\$](#) ([Theorem 12.4](#)), there exists $h_1 \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that $h_1 \leq \underline{1}$ and

$$d\nu = h_1 \, d\rho.$$

Define $h_2 := \underline{1} - h_1 \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Then $h_1 + h_2 = \underline{1}$.

Fix $E \in \mathfrak{M}$. Since $d\nu = h_1 \, d\rho$ and $\rho = \mu + \nu$, [Sum of positive measures](#) ([Definition and Remark 13.1](#)) gives

$$\nu(E) = \int_E h_1 \, d\rho = \int_E h_1 \, d\mu + \int_E h_1 \, d\nu.$$

On the other hand, $h_1 + h_2 = \underline{1}$ gives

$$\nu(E) = \int_E (h_1 + h_2) \, d\nu = \int_E h_1 \, d\nu + \int_E h_2 \, d\nu.$$

All the terms are finite, since $0 \leq h_1, h_2 \leq \underline{1}$ and μ, ν are finite. Cancelling the common term therefore yields

$$\int_E h_1 \, d\mu = \int_E h_2 \, d\nu, \quad \forall E \in \mathfrak{M}.$$

The two sides define positive measures on $\mathfrak{M}$ by [Proposition 7.9](#), and the preceding equality shows that these measures are equal. Applying [Proposition 7.10](#) to each of them gives

$$\int_X g \cdot h_1 \, d\mu = \int_X g \cdot h_2 \, d\nu, \quad \forall g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}),$$

which is $(\heartsuit)$. □

For the connecting equation, it will be useful to understand the points at which one of $h_1(x)$ and $h_2(x)$ is zero and the other is one.

Lemma 13.3

In the framework of [Trick of the connecting equation \(Proposition 13.2\)](#), let

$$S := \{x \in X \mid h_2(x) = 0\} = \{x \in X \mid h_1(x) = 1\}.$$

Then $\mu(S) = 0$.

Proof: Substitute $g = \chi_S$ into $(\heartsuit)$. Since $h_1 = \underline{1}$ and $h_2 = \underline{0}$ on S , we obtain

$$\mu(S) = \int_S h_1 \, d\mu = \int_S h_2 \, d\nu = 0.$$

□

13.2 Radon-Nikodym, version with absolute continuity $\nu \ll \mu$ **Definition 13.4****Absolute continuity of measures**

Let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be positive measures. We say that ν is *absolutely continuous with respect to* μ , denoted $\nu \ll \mu$, if

$$A \in \mathfrak{M} \quad \text{and} \quad \mu(A) = 0 \implies \nu(A) = 0.$$

Remark 13.5

Comparing the definitions of $\nu \leq \mu$ and $\nu \ll \mu$, we immediately obtain

$$\nu \leq \mu \implies \nu \ll \mu.$$

The converse does not hold in general.

Remark 13.6**Absolute continuity obtained from a density**

Let $\mu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be a positive measure and let $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Recall that

$$\nu(A) := \int_A h \, d\mu = \int_X h \cdot \chi_A \, d\mu, \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{M},$$

defines a positive measure ν .

Unlike in [Domination obtained by integrating a density \(Remark 12.3\)](#), we do not assume that $h(x) \leq 1$; the function h may even be unbounded. Consequently, $\nu \leq \mu$ need not hold. For example, if

$$A := \{x \in X \mid h(x) \geq 2\}$$

satisfies $\mu(A) > 0$, then

$$\nu(A) \geq 2\mu(A) > \mu(A).$$

Nevertheless, the measure obtained from any such density always satisfies $\nu \ll \mu$.

Theorem 13.7**Radon-Nikodym theorem**

Let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ be finite positive measures such that $\nu \ll \mu$. Then there exists $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$d\nu = h d\mu;$$

that is,

$$\nu(A) = \int_A h d\mu, \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{M}.$$

Moreover, h is unique in the a.e- μ sense: if $\tilde{h} \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ also satisfies $d\nu = \tilde{h} d\mu$, then $\tilde{h} = h$ a.e- μ .

Proof: Let h_1, h_2 be as in [Trick of the connecting equation \(Proposition 13.2\)](#), and put

$$S := \{x \in X \mid h_2(x) = 0\} \quad \text{and} \quad A := X \setminus S.$$

By [Lemma 13.3](#), $\mu(S) = 0$. Since $\nu \ll \mu$, we also have $\nu(S) = 0$. Moreover, $h_2(x) > 0$ for every $x \in A$.

Define $h : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$h(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{h_1(x)}{h_2(x)} & \text{if } x \in A \\ 0 & \text{if } x \in S \end{cases}.$$

The sets A, S are measurable, and the quotient $\frac{h_1}{h_2}$ is non-negative and Borel measurable on A , so $h \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Fix $f \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ and define $g : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$g(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{f(x)}{h_2(x)} & \text{if } x \in A \\ 0 & \text{if } x \in S \end{cases}.$$

As above, $g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$. Applying $(\heartsuit)$ to g gives

$$\int_X f \cdot h d\mu = \int_A g \cdot h_1 d\mu = \int_A g \cdot h_2 d\nu = \int_A f d\nu = \int_X f d\nu.$$

In the first and last equalities, we used $\mu(S) = \nu(S) = 0$. Taking $f = \chi_E$ for each $E \in \mathfrak{M}$ shows that

$$\nu(E) = \int_E h d\mu, \quad \forall E \in \mathfrak{M},$$

and hence $d\nu = h d\mu$.

For uniqueness, suppose $\tilde{h} \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ also satisfies $d\nu = \tilde{h} d\mu$. Define

$$P := \{x \in X \mid h(x) > \tilde{h}(x)\} \quad \text{and} \quad N := \{x \in X \mid h(x) < \tilde{h}(x)\}.$$

Both sets are measurable. The functions h and $\tilde{h}$ are integrable because their integrals over X equal the finite number $\nu(X)$. Since their integrals over every measurable set are equal, we have

$$\int_P (h - \tilde{h}) \, d\mu = \nu(P) - \nu(P) = 0.$$

The integrand is non-negative and is strictly positive precisely on P . Thus [Remark 8.12](#) and [Proposition 8.9](#) give $\mu(P) = 0$. Applying the same argument to $\tilde{h} - h$ on N gives $\mu(N) = 0$. Since

$$\{x \in X \mid h(x) \neq \tilde{h}(x)\} = P \cup N,$$

we conclude that $h = \tilde{h}$ a.e.- μ . □

14 Some R-N related stuff

14.1 The Lebesgue decomposition theorem

The Lebesgue decomposition theorem can be derived using the same connecting-equation trick as [Trick of the connecting equation](#) ([Proposition 13.2](#)).

Definition 14.1

Concentrated and mutually singular measures

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ be a measurable space.

1. Let $\mu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be a positive measure and let $P \in \mathfrak{M}$. We say that μ is *concentrated on* P if

$$\mu(X \setminus P) = 0.$$

2. Let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be positive measures. We say that μ and ν are *mutually singular*, denoted $\mu \perp \nu$, if there exist disjoint sets $P, Q \in \mathfrak{M}$ such that μ is concentrated on P and ν is concentrated on Q .

Theorem and Definition 14.2

Lebesgue decomposition

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ be a measurable space, and let $\mu, \nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ be finite positive measures. There exist unique finite positive measures $\nu_1, \nu_2 : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ such that

- (i) $\nu_1 + \nu_2 = \nu$;
- (ii) $\nu_1 \ll \mu$;
- (iii) $\nu_2 \perp \mu$.

The measure ν_1 is called the *absolutely continuous part of ν with respect to μ* , and ν_2 is called the *singular part of ν with respect to μ* . The relation $\nu = \nu_1 + \nu_2$ is called the *Lebesgue decomposition of ν with respect to μ* .

Remark 14.3

The uniqueness assertion in [Lebesgue decomposition](#) ([Theorem and Definition 14.2](#)) is an elementary verification. For existence, we use ($\heartsuit$) for the measures μ and ν .

Proof of existence in [Lebesgue decomposition](#) ([Theorem and Definition 14.2](#)): Let

$h_1, h_2 \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R})$ be the functions from [Trick of the connecting equation](#) ([Proposition 13.2](#)), so that $h_1 + h_2 = \underline{1}$ and

$$\int_X g \cdot h_1 \, d\mu = \int_X g \cdot h_2 \, d\nu, \quad \forall g \in \text{Bor}^+(X, \mathbb{R}).$$

Recall from [Lemma 13.3](#) that, upon defining

$$S := \{x \in X \mid h_1(x) = 1\} = \{x \in X \mid h_2(x) = 0\} \in \mathfrak{M}, \quad (14.1)$$

we have $\mu(S) = 0$.

Use S to decompose ν : define $\nu_1, \nu_2 : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ by

$$\nu_1(A) := \nu(A \cap (X \setminus S)) \quad \text{and} \quad \nu_2(A) := \nu(A \cap S), \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{M}. \quad (14.2)$$

These formulas define finite positive measures. Moreover, for every $A \in \mathfrak{M}$,

$$\begin{aligned} \nu_1(A) + \nu_2(A) &= \nu(A \cap (X \setminus S)) + \nu(A \cap S) \\ &= \nu((A \cap (X \setminus S)) \cup (A \cap S)) \\ &= \nu(A), \end{aligned}$$

where additivity applies because the union is disjoint. Hence $\nu_1 + \nu_2 = \nu$.

It remains to verify the other two properties.

Claim 1: $\nu_2 \perp \mu$.

Verification of Claim 1: By definition, ν_2 is concentrated on S , since

$$\nu_2(X \setminus S) = \nu((X \setminus S) \cap S) = \nu(\emptyset) = 0.$$

The measure μ is concentrated on $X \setminus S$, since

$$\mu(X \setminus (X \setminus S)) = \mu(S) = 0.$$

These two sets are disjoint, so $\nu_2 \perp \mu$.

Claim 2: $\nu_1 \ll \mu$.

Verification of Claim 2: Fix $A \in \mathfrak{M}$ with $\mu(A) = 0$. We must show that

$$\nu_1(A) = \nu(A \cap (X \setminus S)) = 0.$$

Since $\mu(A) = 0$, we have $\chi_A \cdot h_1 = 0$ a.e.- μ . Therefore [Lemma 8.10](#) and $(\heartsuit)$, with $g = \chi_A$, give

$$\int_X \chi_A \cdot h_2 \, d\nu = \int_X \chi_A \cdot h_1 \, d\mu = 0.$$

Applying [Remark 8.12](#) with respect to ν , we find that $\chi_A \cdot h_2$ vanishes almost everywhere with respect to ν . Its nonzero set is

$$\{x \in X \mid \chi_A(x) \cdot h_2(x) \neq 0\} = A \cap (X \setminus S).$$

Consequently, $\nu(A \cap (X \setminus S)) = 0$, as required.

□

14.2 Conditional expectations

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a probability space. An important application of the Radon–Nikodym theorem is that it allows us to define the conditional expectation of an integrable function onto a sub-sigma-algebra $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$.

Notation and Remark 14.4

Measurability with respect to different sigma-algebras

Suppose $(X, \mathfrak{M})$ is a measurable space and $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$ is a sigma-algebra of subsets of X . We use the notation

$$\text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{M}), \mathbb{R}) := \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \mid f^{-1}(B) \in \mathfrak{M} \text{ for every } B \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}\} \quad (14.3)$$

and, in parallel,

$$\text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R}) := \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \mid f^{-1}(B) \in \mathfrak{N} \text{ for every } B \in \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}\}. \quad (14.4)$$

This makes explicit which sigma-algebra is used for measurability. Since $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$, we have

$$\text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R}) \subseteq \text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{M}), \mathbb{R}).$$

The inclusion can be strict, and $\text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R})$ can be much smaller than $\text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{M}), \mathbb{R})$.

Example 14.5

Measurability with respect to a finite sigma-algebra

Let $X = [0, 1]$ and $\mathfrak{M} = \mathcal{B}_{[0,1]}$. Partition

$$[0, 1] = J_1 \cup J_2 \cup J_3,$$

where

$$J_1 = \left[0, \frac{1}{3}\right], \quad J_2 = \left(\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{2}\right], \quad J_3 = \left(\frac{1}{2}, 1\right].$$

Define

$$\mathfrak{N} := \{\emptyset, J_1, J_2, J_3, J_1 \cup J_2, J_1 \cup J_3, J_2 \cup J_3, X\}. \quad (14.5)$$

Then $\mathfrak{N}$ is a sigma-algebra and $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$. The space $\text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{M}), \mathbb{R})$ is infinite-dimensional; for example, it contains every continuous function $f : [0, 1] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. On the other hand,

$$g \in \text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R}) \iff g \text{ is constant on each of } J_1, J_2, J_3. \quad (14.6)$$

Consequently,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Bor}((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R}) &= \text{span}\{\chi_{J_1}, \chi_{J_2}, \chi_{J_3}\} \\ &= \left\{ \alpha_1 \chi_{J_1} + \alpha_2 \chi_{J_2} + \alpha_3 \chi_{J_3} \mid \alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3 \in \mathbb{R} \right\}. \end{aligned} \quad (14.7)$$

The verification of (14.6) and (14.7) is left as an exercise.

Lemma 14.6**Restriction of a measure to a sub-sigma-algebra**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a measure space with $\mu(X) < \infty$, and let $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$ be a sigma-algebra. Define $\mu_o : \mathfrak{N} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ by

$$\mu_o(N) := \mu(N), \quad \forall N \in \mathfrak{N}.$$

Then μ_o is a finite positive measure on $\mathfrak{N}$, and

$$\int_X g \, d\mu_o = \int_X g \, d\mu, \quad \forall g \in \text{Bor}^+((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R}). \quad (14.8)$$

The proof of [Restriction of a measure to a sub-sigma-algebra \(Lemma 14.6\)](#) is left as an exercise. One approach is to apply [Method of the friendly functions \(Lemma 6.9\)](#) to

$$\mathcal{G} := \left\{ g \in \text{Bor}^+((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R}) \mid \int_X g \, d\mu_o = \int_X g \, d\mu \right\}.$$

Definition 14.7**Conditional expectation**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a measure space with $\mu(X) < \infty$, let $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$ be a sigma-algebra, and let μ_o be the restriction of μ to $\mathfrak{N}$. For $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$, a function $g : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is called a (*version of the*) *conditional expectation of f onto $\mathfrak{N}$* if $g \in \mathcal{L}^1(X, \mathfrak{N}, \mu_o)$ and

$$\int_N g \, d\mu_o = \int_N f \, d\mu, \quad \forall N \in \mathfrak{N}. \quad (14.9)$$

Comment

The function f in (14.9) need not be $\mathfrak{N}/\mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$ -measurable, so the integral of $\chi_N \cdot f$ may not make sense on the measure space $(X, \mathfrak{N}, \mu_o)$. The purpose of g is to replace f by an $\mathfrak{N}/\mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$ -measurable function while preserving its integrals over sets in $\mathfrak{N}$.

Proposition 14.8**Existence for non-negative functions**

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a measure space with $\mu(X) < \infty$, let $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$ be a sigma-algebra, and let $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ satisfy

$$f(x) \geq 0, \quad \forall x \in X.$$

Then f has a conditional expectation g onto $\mathfrak{N}$, where g may be chosen so that $g(x) \geq 0$ for every $x \in X$.

Proof: Define a finite positive measure $\nu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ by $d\nu = f \, d\mu$; explicitly,

$$\nu(A) := \int_A f \, d\mu, \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{M}.$$

It is finite because

$$\nu(X) = \int_X f \, d\mu < \infty,$$

and [Absolute continuity obtained from a density \(Remark 13.6\)](#) gives $\nu \ll \mu$.

Let μ_o and ν_o be the restrictions of μ and ν to $\mathfrak{N}$. They are finite positive measures on $\mathfrak{N}$. Moreover, $\nu_o \ll \mu_o$: if $N \in \mathfrak{N}$ and $\mu_o(N) = 0$, then

$$\mu(N) = 0 \implies \nu(N) = 0 \implies \nu_o(N) = 0.$$

Apply [Radon-Nikodym theorem \(Theorem 13.7\)](#) on the measurable space $(X, \mathfrak{N})$. There exists $g \in \text{Bor}^+((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R})$ such that

$$d\nu_o = g \, d\mu_o.$$

For every $N \in \mathfrak{N}$, it follows that

$$\int_N g \, d\mu_o = \nu_o(N) = \nu(N) = \int_N f \, d\mu.$$

Furthermore,

$$\int_X g \, d\mu_o = \nu_o(X) = \nu(X) = \int_X f \, d\mu < \infty.$$

Hence $g \in \mathcal{L}^1(X, \mathfrak{N}, \mu_o)$. Since g is non-negative, it has all the required properties. $\square$

Corollary 14.9

Existence and uniqueness of conditional expectation

Let $(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$ be a measure space with $\mu(X) < \infty$, let $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}$ be a sigma-algebra, and let $f \in \mathcal{L}^1(X, \mathfrak{M}, \mu)$.

1. The function f has a conditional expectation onto $\mathfrak{N}$.
2. If g, g' are two versions of the conditional expectation of f onto $\mathfrak{N}$, then there exists $Z \in \mathfrak{N}$ with $\mu(Z) = 0$ such that

$$g(x) = g'(x), \quad \forall x \in X \setminus Z.$$

The proof of [Existence and uniqueness of conditional expectation \(Corollary 14.9\)](#) is left as an exercise. For existence, apply [Existence for non-negative functions \(Proposition 14.8\)](#) separately to f_+ and f_- . For uniqueness, apply the almost-everywhere criterion to $|g - g'| \in \text{Bor}^+((X, \mathfrak{N}), \mathbb{R})$.

Notation 14.10

Conditional expectation

In the framework of [Existence and uniqueness of conditional expectation \(Corollary 14.9\)](#), a conditional expectation of f onto $\mathfrak{N}$ is commonly denoted by

$$g = E[f \mid \mathfrak{N}].$$

Thus $E[f \mid \mathfrak{N}] \in \mathcal{L}^1(X, \mathfrak{N}, \mu_o)$. It is not uniquely determined as a function; it is determined only up to equality almost everywhere with respect to μ_o .

15 How to construct positive measures via the Carathéodory extension theorem

15.1 Motivation for an extension theorem

Remark 15.1

Important examples of positive measures on the Borel sigma-algebra $\mathcal{B}_X$ of a metric space (X, d) often have the following features:

- (a) There is no intrinsic description of a general set $B \in \mathcal{B}_X$ and no explicit procedure for assigning it a measure $\mu(B)$.
- (b) There is a convenient algebra $\mathfrak{A}$ which generates $\mathcal{B}_X$. The sets in $\mathfrak{A}$ have an explicit description, and there is a formula defining an additive set-function $\mu_o : \mathfrak{A} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$.

We therefore want conditions guaranteeing that μ_o extends to a positive measure on $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{A})$. The relevant condition is that μ_o be a pre-measure.

Example 15.2**Lebesgue–Stieltjes setup**

Let $X = \mathbb{R}$ with its usual metric, and consider the semi-algebra

$$\mathfrak{J} = \{\emptyset\} \cup \{(a, b] \mid a < b \text{ in } \mathbb{R}\} \cup \{(-\infty, b] \mid b \in \mathbb{R}\} \cup \{(a, \infty) \mid a \in \mathbb{R}\} \cup \{\mathbb{R}\}.$$

As for any semi-algebra, the algebra $\mathfrak{A} := \text{Alg}(\mathfrak{J})$ has the explicit description

$$\mathfrak{A} := \left\{ A \subseteq \mathbb{R} \mid \begin{array}{l} \text{there exist } k \in \mathbb{N} \text{ and } J_1 \dots J_k \in \mathfrak{J} \\ J_i \cap J_j = \emptyset \text{ for } i \neq j \\ J_1 \cup \dots \cup J_k = A \end{array} \right\}.$$

Since $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{J}) = \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$, we also have $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{A}) = \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}}$.

Let $G : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be increasing. The limits of G at $+\infty$ exist; denote them by

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} G(t) =: \ell_+ \in \mathbb{R} \cup \{\infty\} \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{s \rightarrow -\infty} G(s) =: \ell_- \in \mathbb{R} \cup \{-\infty\}.$$

Define $\mu_o : \mathfrak{J} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ by $\mu_o(\emptyset) = 0$ and

$$\mu_o((a, b]) := G(b) - G(a) \in [0, \infty), \quad \forall a < b \text{ in } \mathbb{R}, \quad (15.1)$$

together with

$$\begin{aligned} \mu_o((-\infty, b]) &:= G(b) - \ell_- \in [0, \infty], \quad \forall b \in \mathbb{R}, \\ \mu_o((a, \infty)) &:= \ell_+ - G(a) \in [0, \infty], \quad \forall a \in \mathbb{R}, \\ \mu_o(\mathbb{R}) &:= \ell_+ - \ell_- \in [0, \infty]. \end{aligned} \quad (15.2)$$

The usual extension from a semi-algebra gives an additive set-function, still denoted $\mu_o : \mathfrak{A} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$.

The question is whether μ_o extends to a positive measure $\mu : \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$. If G is cadlag, then μ_o is a pre-measure, and the Carathéodory extension theorem gives such an extension. Cadlag functions are discussed below.

15.2 Pre-measures and the Carathéodory extension theorem

Definition 15.3**Pre-measure**

Let X be non-empty, let $\mathfrak{A}$ be an algebra of subsets of X , and let $\mu_o : \mathfrak{A} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be additive. We call μ_o a *pre-measure* if it satisfies the following pre-sigma-additivity condition:

whenever $(A_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is a pairwise disjoint sequence in $\mathfrak{A}$ such that $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n$ also belongs to $\mathfrak{A}$, one has

$$\mu_o\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu_o(A_n).$$

Comment

The algebra $\mathfrak{A}$ need not be a sigma-algebra, so a countable union of its sets may leave $\mathfrak{A}$. Pre-sigma-additivity only imposes the sigma-additivity formula when the union happens to remain in $\mathfrak{A}$.

This condition is necessary for extending μ_o to a positive measure on $\sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{A})$. The Carathéodory theorem says that it is also sufficient.

Theorem 15.4**Carathéodory extension theorem**

Let X be non-empty, let $\mathfrak{A}$ be an algebra of subsets of X , and put

$$\mathfrak{M} := \sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{A}).$$

If $\mu_o : \mathfrak{A} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ is a pre-measure, then there exists a positive measure $\mu : \mathfrak{M} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ extending μ_o ; that is,

$$\mu(A) = \mu_o(A), \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{A}.$$

We will not prove [Carathéodory extension theorem \(Theorem 15.4\)](#) in detail. Instead, we describe its blueprint.

Remark 15.5**Carathéodory's idea**

The proof follows an *overshoot-and-trim-down* strategy:

$$\mathfrak{A} \longrightarrow 2^X \longrightarrow \mathfrak{M} = \sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{A}).$$

First extend μ_o to a set-function $\mu^* : 2^X \rightarrow [0, \infty]$. This extension will generally not be a positive measure, but it will be an outer measure. Then find a sigma-algebra $\mathfrak{G}$ satisfying

$$\mathfrak{A} \subseteq \mathfrak{G} \subseteq 2^X$$

such that the restriction $\tilde{\mu} := \mu^*|_{\mathfrak{G}}$ is a positive measure.

The strategy works because of the following facts.

1. Since $\mathfrak{G}$ is a sigma-algebra containing $\mathfrak{A}$,

$$\mathfrak{G} \supseteq \sigma\text{-Alg}(\mathfrak{A}) = \mathfrak{M}.$$

2. The restriction $\mu := \tilde{\mu}|_{\mathfrak{M}}$ is a positive measure on $\mathfrak{M}$.
3. For every $A \in \mathfrak{A}$,

$$\mu(A) = \tilde{\mu}(A) = \mu^*(A) = \mu_o(A),$$

so μ extends μ_o .

Definition 15.6**Outer measure**

Let X be non-empty. A function $\mu^* : 2^X \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ is called an *outer measure* if it satisfies:

- (OM1) $\mu^*(\emptyset) = 0$;
- (OM2) μ^* is increasing: if $E \subseteq F \subseteq X$, then $\mu^*(E) \leq \mu^*(F)$;
- (OM3) μ^* is countably subadditive: for every sequence $(E_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ of subsets of X ,

$$\mu^*\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^\infty E_n\right) \leq \sum_{n=1}^\infty \mu^*(E_n).$$

The overshoot step and the two parts of the trim-down step are recorded precisely below. Their proofs are omitted.

Proposition 15.7**The overshoot step of Carathéodory**

Let X be non-empty, let $\mathfrak{A}$ be an algebra of subsets of X , and let $\mu_o : \mathfrak{A} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be a pre-measure. For every $E \subseteq X$, define

$$\mu^*(E) := \inf \left\{ \sum_{n=1}^\infty \mu_o(A_n) \mid \begin{array}{l} A_n \in \mathfrak{A} \text{ for every } n \in \mathbb{N} \\ \bigcup_{n=1}^\infty A_n \supseteq E \end{array} \right\}. \quad (15.3)$$

Then:

1. μ^* is an outer measure;
2. μ^* extends μ_o , meaning

$$\mu^*(A) = \mu_o(A), \quad \forall A \in \mathfrak{A}.$$

Comment

A sequence $(A_n)_{n=1}^\infty$ satisfying $\bigcup_{n=1}^\infty A_n \supseteq E$ is called a *countable cover* of E . Thus (15.3) takes the infimum over all countable covers of E by sets from $\mathfrak{A}$.

Such covers always exist: take $A_1 = X$ and $A_n = \emptyset$ for every $n \geq 2$.

Proposition 15.8**The trim-down step of Carathéodory, Part 1**

Let X be non-empty and let $\mu^* : 2^X \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be an outer measure. Say that $G \subseteq X$ is a *good separator* for μ^* if, whenever $E \subseteq G$ and $F \subseteq X \setminus G$,

$$\mu^*(E \cup F) = \mu^*(E) + \mu^*(F).$$

Then:

1. the collection

$$\mathfrak{G} := \{G \subseteq X \mid G \text{ is a good separator for } \mu^*\}$$

is a sigma-algebra;

2. the restriction $\tilde{\mu} := \mu^*|_{\mathfrak{G}}$ is a positive measure on $\mathfrak{G}$.

Proposition 15.9**The trim-down step of Carathéodory, Part 2**

In the framework of [The overshoot step of Carathéodory \(Proposition 15.7\)](#), every $A \in \mathfrak{A}$ is a good separator for μ^* in the sense of [The trim-down step of Carathéodory, Part 1 \(Proposition 15.8\)](#).

15.3 Lebesgue–Stieltjes measures on the real line

Return to the increasing function $G : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ from [Lebesgue–Stieltjes setup \(Example 15.2\)](#).

Definition 15.10**Cadlag function**

The function G is *cadlag* if it is right-continuous at every $b \in \mathbb{R}$; that is,

$$\lim_{s \searrow b} G(s) = G(b), \quad \forall b \in \mathbb{R}. \quad (15.4)$$

The word *cadlag* comes from the French phrase *continue à droite, limite à gauche*: continuous from the right, with limits from the left.

Since G is increasing, for every $a \in \mathbb{R}$ the limit

$$\lim_{t \nearrow a} G(t) \quad (15.5)$$

exists and is at most $G(a)$, but may be strictly smaller.

Proposition and Definition 15.11**Lebesgue–Stieltjes measure**

Suppose the increasing function $G : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ from [Lebesgue–Stieltjes setup \(Example 15.2\)](#) is cadlag. Then the additive set-function $\mu_o : \mathfrak{A} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ constructed there is a pre-measure, and hence extends to a positive measure $\mu : \mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$.

The resulting measure μ is called the *Lebesgue–Stieltjes measure defined by G* . It is uniquely determined by

$$\mu((a, b]) = G(b) - G(a), \quad \forall a < b \text{ in } \mathbb{R}.$$

Remark 15.12

How does the cadlag property arise in [Lebesgue–Stieltjes setup \(Example 15.2\)](#)? Where does the asymmetry between left and right come from?